

PARIKSHA365 — STUDY NOTES

Science & Technology — Common Book

SSC, RRB, Banks (GA), State PSC — ISRO, DRDO,
Computers, Defence Tech

SSC

RRB

BANKS

STATE PSC

v 2026-04

The promise. Read this book end-to-end (with the usual two re-reads + active recall on the embedded prompts) and you will be able to attempt every quiz question in the Pariksha365 pool for this subject with a strong fundamental grasp.

EXAMINER BLUEPRINT — What Gets Tested Most

Science & Technology is one of the most scoring sections.

- Questions are almost entirely **factual**.
- No derivation, no calculation.
- Just "Which mission did what" or "Which organisation developed X."
- Knowing the right list gets you full marks.

EXAM ALERT

Top 8 Sci-Tech exam hotspots

1. **ISRO missions** — Chandrayaan series, Mangalyaan, Aditya-L1, Gaganyaan, SpaDeX. Know each mission's objective, launch vehicle, and year. Appears in every SSC, RRB, and Banking exam.
2. **DRDO missiles** — Agni series, Prithvi series, BrahMos, Akash, Tejas. Know range, type (surface-to-surface, supersonic cruise), and developer.
3. **Nobel Prize winners** — last 3–5 years across Physics, Chemistry, Medicine/Physiology. Examiners ask year + field + discovery.
4. **Computer fundamentals** — generations of computers, OSI model (7 layers), storage units (1 byte = 8 bits), programming generations.
5. **Biotechnology** — PCR, CRISPR, cloning, vaccines (live attenuated vs killed vs mRNA). These appear in SSC and UPSC papers.
6. **Nuclear technology** — fission vs fusion, types of reactors (PWR, BWR, PHWR), India's 3-stage nuclear programme, BARC vs ISRO vs DRDO roles.
7. **Defence platforms** — INS Vikrant (aircraft carrier), Tejas, AMCA, Arjun tank, Arihant-class submarines.
8. **Space organisations** — NASA (USA), ESA (Europe), Roscosmos (Russia), CNSA (China), JAXA (Japan). Know 2–3 key missions each.

KEY FACT

Study priority for time-poor students

1. ISRO missions — all with years and objectives
2. DRDO missiles — Agni I through V ranges, BrahMos specs
3. Nobel Prize winners — last 3 years
4. Computer fundamentals — OSI model, storage, generations
5. Biotechnology basics — vaccines, CRISPR, DNA vs RNA
6. India's nuclear programme — 3 stages + key reactors
7. Defence platforms — aircraft carrier, submarines, fighter jets
8. Space milestones (global) — first human in space, Moon landing, Mars missions

What's New This Year (Sci-Tech)

*ISRO/DRDO missions, Nobel laureates, AI/tech companies' product versions, Indian-tech milestones change frequently. Re-check before any exam later than Q3 2026. The rest of this book (general physics/chemistry/biology fundamentals, computer-architecture basics, OSI 7 layers, programming-language histories, MS Office shortcuts, internet milestone history pre-2024) is **static and stable**.*

Item	Current value (verify before your exam)
Nobel 2025 — Physics	John Clarke + Michel H. Devoret + John M. Martinis (macroscopic quantum tunnelling)
Nobel 2025 — Chemistry	Susumu Kitagawa + Richard Robson + Omar M. Yaghi (Metal-Organic Frameworks)
Nobel 2025 — Medicine	Mary Brunkow + Frederick Ramsdell + Shimon Sakaguchi (regulatory T cells)
ISRO recent missions	Chandrayaan-3 (23 Aug 2023 lunar landing); Aditya-L1 (Sep 2023, L1 reached Jan 2024); SpaDeX (30 Dec 2024, docking 16 Jan 2025); NISAR (30 Jul 2025 GSLV-F16)
Gaganyaan	Uncrewed G1 = H2 2026 (with Vyommitra robot); first crewed mission = H1 2027
DRDO recent	Mission Divyastra (Agni-V MIRV, Mar 2024); Agni-V test Aug 2025; Scramjet long-duration test Jan 2026
Defence platforms	INS Vikrant (commissioned 2 Sep 2022); INS Arighat (Aug 2024); HAL Tejas Mk-1A (delivery 2024)
CBDC	Digital Rupee (₹): Wholesale pilot Nov 2022; Retail pilot Dec 2022; live in 9 cities
5G	India 2nd-largest 5G user base; 394 million users end-2025; 1 billion broadband subscribers Nov 2025
CRISPR therapy	Casgevy (first CRISPR therapy approved by FDA Dec 2023) — sickle cell + β -thalassemia

How to use this book

Sci-Tech questions are almost entirely about four things:

- **Names** — ISRO, DRDO, BARC, BrahMos, INS Vikrant.
- **Years** — when launched / commissioned.
- **Organisations** — who developed it.
- **One-line description** — range, payload, purpose.

No calculation required. This makes Sci-Tech the easiest scoring section — IF you commit the right tables to memory.

Why each chapter starts with a story:

- Understanding **why** a system was built makes the specific facts (range, year, mechanism) **stick far better** than raw memorisation.
- Read the story → drill the table at the end.

The "Exam hooks" section is your most important page in every chapter:

- It is the **compressed list** of exactly what examiners have asked.
- After reading, **close the book**, answer those points from memory.
- If you can → move on.
- If you cannot → re-read only the section you struggled with, and try again.

***The truth about Sci-Tech:** Students who can recall "BrahMos: 290 km range, Mach 2.8, surface-surface-air-sea, Indo-Russian joint venture" in 5 seconds beat students who "understood" it perfectly but can't retrieve it under pressure. This book is built to get you to that 5-second recall speed.*

How to read this book — your real study load

Total pages: 58. Don't let the page count scare you.

Mandatory reading — pages 1 to 29 (50% of the book)

That's the full syllabus. Master those 29 pages and you've covered every concept an examiner can fairly ask.

Bonus material — pages 30 to 58 (50% of the book)

Reference tables, compilations, and self-test material — useful in your last week of revision OR if you're aiming for a top rank.

Two study tracks

- **Just want to pass?** Read pages 1–29. Skim the appendices once before the exam.
 - **Want to top your batch?** Read the appendices too — they're how 70% becomes 90%.
-

Index — Table of Contents (clickable)

Pages	Part / Chapter	Topic / What it covers
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p25	PART G	HEALTH & MEDICAL TECH
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p35–38	PART Z	COMPUTER FUNDAMENTALS DEEP-DRILL — <i>Computer Fundamentals Deep-Drill — generations, OSI, Office shortcuts.</i>

Pages	Part / Chapter	Topic / What it covers
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p40–42	PART V	NOBEL PRIZES 2020–2024 (full 5 years) — <i>Nobel Prizes 2020–24 — full 5 years across all fields</i> .
p43–45	PART W	RECENT (2024–26) SCIENCE & TECH BREAKTHROUGHS — <i>Recent Science Breakthroughs (2024–26)</i> — <i>CRISPR, AI milestones</i> .
p46–47	PART U	SCI-TECH MINI-MOCK (25 Questions · 25 Minutes) — <i>25-Question Mini-Mock — timed self-test</i> .
p48–58	PART T	COMPUTER AWARENESS DEEP-DRILL (Banks GA + SSC + RRB) — <i>Computer Awareness Deep-Drill — Banks GA + SSC + RRB extra</i> .

PART A — SPACE TECHNOLOGY: INDIA'S JOURNEY FROM THUMBA TO THE MOON

Chapter A1 — The Story of ISRO: From Coconut Groves to Cosmos

Background

From bicycles to the moon — ISRO's arc.

- **1962, Thumba, Kerala** — a fishing village; a Jesuit church converted into a rocket workshop.
- Parts carted on **bicycles**.
- First Indian rocket — a Nike-Apache — launched **21 November 1963**.
- **63 years later** — Chandrayaan-3 lands near the **lunar south pole** (23 Aug 2023).
- India becomes the **first country** ever to do so.

Why India needs a space programme

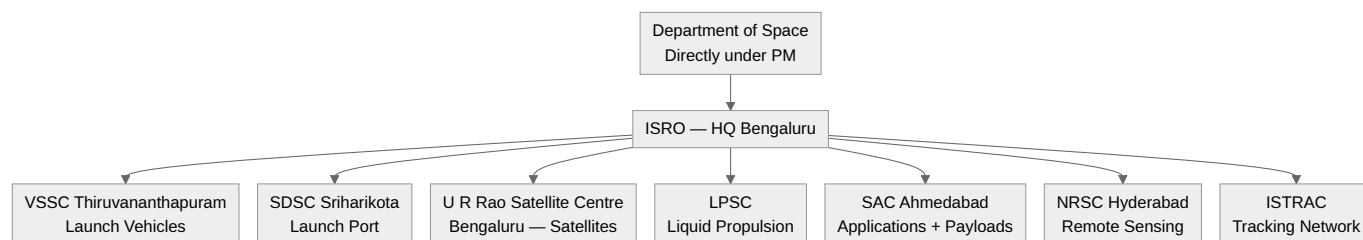
Vikram Sarabhai's vision (1963):

*"There is no ambiguity of purpose. We must be **second to none** in the application of advanced technologies to the real problems of man and society."*

Translation — India's space programme exists for **development**, not prestige:

- Weather forecasting
- Communication (TV, telephony)
- Education (EDUSAT)
- Resource mapping (RESOURCESAT)
- Disaster response

Organisational Tree



Launch Vehicles — The PSLV → GSLV → LVM3 → SSLV Ladder

Vehicle	Full form	Payload LEO	Signature role
SLV-3 (1980)	Satellite Launch Vehicle	40 kg	First Indian launcher (Rohini D1)
ASLV (1987-94)	Augmented SLV	150 kg	Learning platform
PSLV (1993-)	Polar Satellite Launch Vehicle	1750 kg (SSO)	ISRO's warhorse — 104 sats in one go (2017)
GSLV Mk-II (2001-)	Geosync SLV	2.5 t (GTO)	Cryogenic upper stage (indigenous from 2014)
LVM3 (GSLV Mk-III)	Launch Vehicle Mark 3	4 t (GTO) / 8 t (LEO)	Chandrayaan-2, Chandrayaan-3, Gaganyaan
SSLV (2022-)	Small Satellite LV	500 kg (LEO)	Cheap, on-demand launches

Memory aid: "The Launchpad Walk"

Picture yourself walking from the gate of **Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota** toward the sea:

1. **Gate** → a **small** rocket waves at you = **SSLV** (small).
2. **Assembly building** → the **warhorse PSLV** is being stacked (**P**olar orbits, **Sun**-sync).
3. **Next pad** → **GSLV** stands taller with its cryogenic nose (**G**eostationary, cold fuel).
4. **Main launch tower** → **LVM3**, the giant that carried Chandrayaan-3.
5. **Beach** → out in the ocean, a future **Gaganyaan** crewed capsule splashes down.

Walk this path in your head three times — you will never forget the launcher hierarchy.

Mission Chronicle — the milestones every exam asks

Year	Mission	What mattered
1975	Aryabhata	First Indian satellite (launched by USSR)
1980	Rohini-1	First satellite launched by an Indian rocket (SLV-3)
1983	INSAT-1B	Beginning of INSAT comm series
1988	IRS-1A	Earth Observation series begins
2008	Chandrayaan-1	Confirmed water molecules on Moon

Year	Mission	What mattered
2013	Mangalyaan / MOM	India = first Asian nation to reach Mars , first country to do so on maiden attempt
2014	GSLV-D5	First successful indigenous cryogenic stage
2017	PSLV-C37	104 satellites in one launch (world record)
2019	Chandrayaan-2	Orbiter success; lander (Vikram) crashed
2020	RISAT-2BR1	Radar-imaging series
2023	Chandrayaan-3	Soft-landing near lunar south pole (23 Aug) — India = 4th country on Moon, 1st near south pole
2023	Aditya-L1	India's first solar observatory (Lagrange-1 point)
2024	XPoSat	X-ray polarimetry satellite (New Year's Day)
2025	SpaDeX	Space Docking Experiment — docking capability demo

KEY FACT

✂ **SHORTCUT — ISRO mission names hint at their targets:** - **Chandrayaan** = **Chandra** (Moon) + *yaan* (vehicle) → Moon mission. - **Mangalyaan** = **Mangal** (Mars) + *yaan* → Mars mission. - **Aditya-L1** = **Aditya** (Sun god) → Solar observatory at Lagrange-1. - **Shukrayaan** = **Shukra** (Venus) → Venus mission (upcoming ~2028). - **Gaganyaan** = **Gagan** (sky/space) + *yaan* → Human spaceflight.

The Sanskrit word always tells you the destination. Use this to decode unfamiliar mission names in MCQ options cold.

Chandrayaan-3 — Mission Details

- **Launch:** 14 July 2023, LVM3-M4, Sriharikota.
- **Arrival:** Lunar orbit 5 Aug; landing 23 Aug 2023, 6:04 PM IST.
- **Landing site** named **Shiv Shakti Point**; Chandrayaan-2 crash site named **Tiranga Point**.
- **National Space Day:** declared for **August 23** every year.
- **Lander:** Vikram. **Rover:** Pragyan (6-wheeled, 26 kg).
- **Firsts:** First near lunar south pole; 4th country to soft-land (after USA, USSR, China).

☀ Aditya-L1

- Launched **2 Sep 2023** on PSLV-C57.
- Placed at **Lagrange Point 1 (L1)**, ~1.5 million km from Earth toward the Sun (continuous Sun view, no eclipses).
- **Seven payloads** — VELC (flagship), SUIT, ASPEX, PAPA, SoLEXS, HELIOS, Magnetometer.

🌐 Navigation, Communication, Earth Observation Constellations

- **NavIC** (IRNSS): 7 satellites, regional navigation for India + 1500 km around.
- **GAGAN:** GPS Aided Geo-Augmented Navigation (for civil aviation, joint with AAI).
- **INSAT + GSAT:** communication & broadcasting.
- **IRS / Cartosat / Resourcesat / Oceansat / RISAT:** Earth observation.

Gaganyaan Programme

- India's first human spaceflight mission. Target: **2026**.
- Crew: **3 astronauts, 3 days, LEO (~400 km)**.
- **Four astronaut-designates** (announced Feb 2024): Group Captains Prashanth Nair, Ajit Krishnan, Angad Pratappa, Shubhanshu Shukla.
- **Abort tests** (TV-D1) already conducted.
- Launcher: **Human-rated LVM3 (HLVM3)**.

Future Missions Roadmap

- **Mangalyaan-2 (MOM-2)** — next Mars mission.
- **Shukrayaan-1** — Venus orbiter (~2028).
- **Chandrayaan-4** — lunar sample return.
- **Bhartiya Antariksh Station (BAS)** — Indian space station by 2035.
- **Crewed lunar landing** by 2040 (announced by PM, Oct 2023).

Exam pointers

- "First country to land near lunar south pole?" → **India (Chandrayaan-3, Aug 23 2023)**.
- "India's first solar mission?" → **Aditya-L1, at L1 Lagrange point**.
- "PSLV world record for satellites in one launch?" → **104 (C37, 2017)**.
- "India's first Mars mission?" → **Mangalyaan (MOM), 2013, success on maiden attempt**.
- "Cryogenic engine first success?" → **GSLV-D5, 2014**.

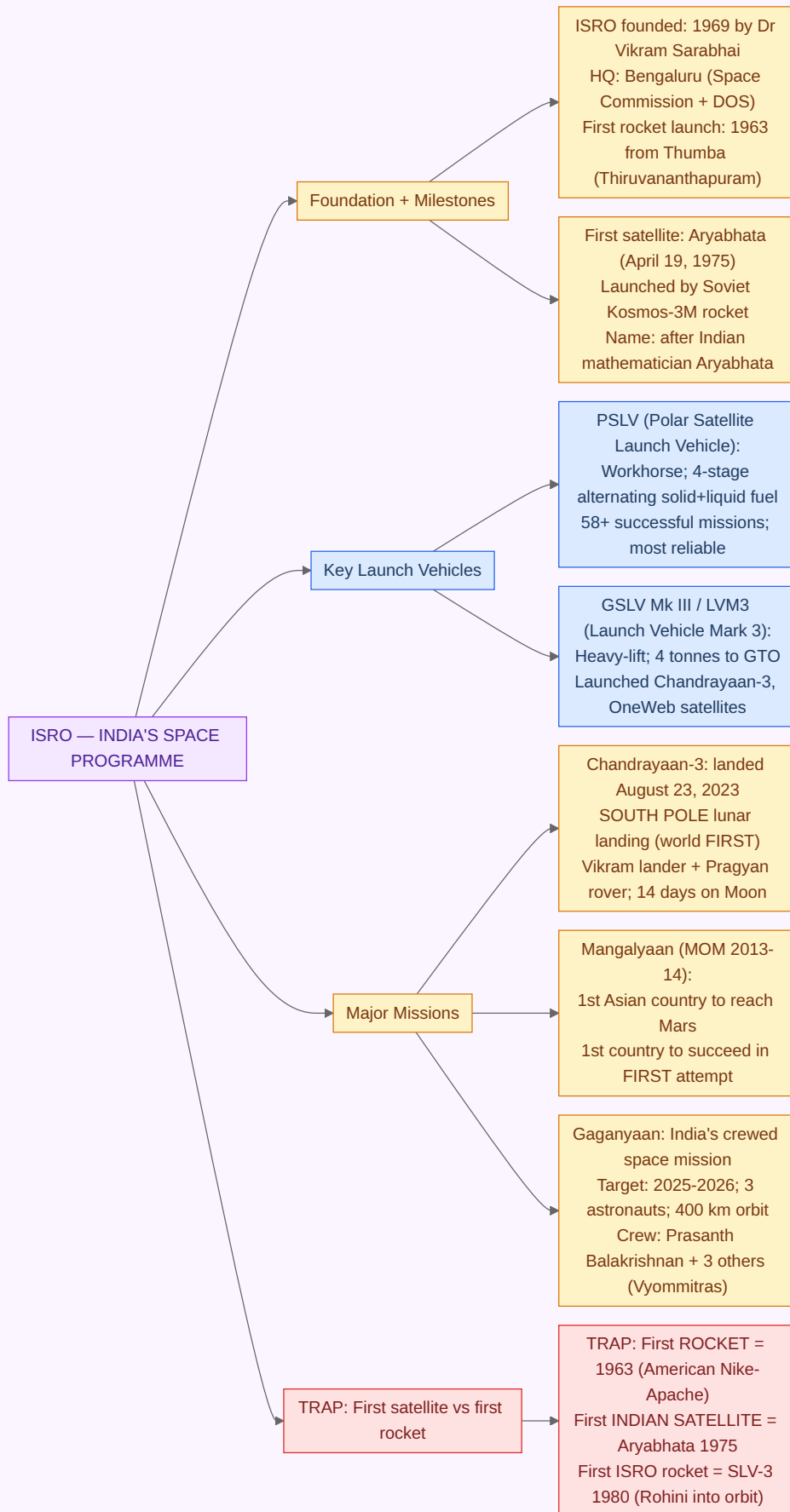
In simple words

Explain to a class 10 student: **PSLV** is India's workhorse rocket — it launches small satellites into a special orbit that lets them see every spot on Earth as it spins (polar). **GSLV** uses a super-cold engine (cryogenic) to throw bigger satellites far up (36,000 km) where they hover over one spot (geostationary). **LVM3** is India's biggest rocket — it took our lander to the Moon.

Practice

1. Name ISRO's four active launch vehicles and one signature mission of each.
2. What is Lagrange Point 1, and why did India choose it for Aditya-L1?
3. Which two countries preceded India in soft-landing on the Moon, and which continent was India first in for Mars?

CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter A2 — Private Space & Global Context

Private Space Sector Reforms

- **2020:** IN-SPACe (Indian National Space Promotion & Authorization Centre) created under DoS; nodal agency for private space activity.
- **NSIL** (New Space India Limited): commercial arm of ISRO (since 2019).
- **Space Policy 2023:** allows private companies to build rockets, satellites, ground systems; FDI up to **100% automatic** in components, **74%** in satellites, **49%** in launch vehicles.
- **Private startups:** Skyroot (Vikram-S, 1st private rocket, 2022), Agnikul (Agnibaan SOrTeD, 2024 — 1st private sub-orbital with 3D-printed engine), Pixxel, Dhruva, Bellatrix.

Global Space Context

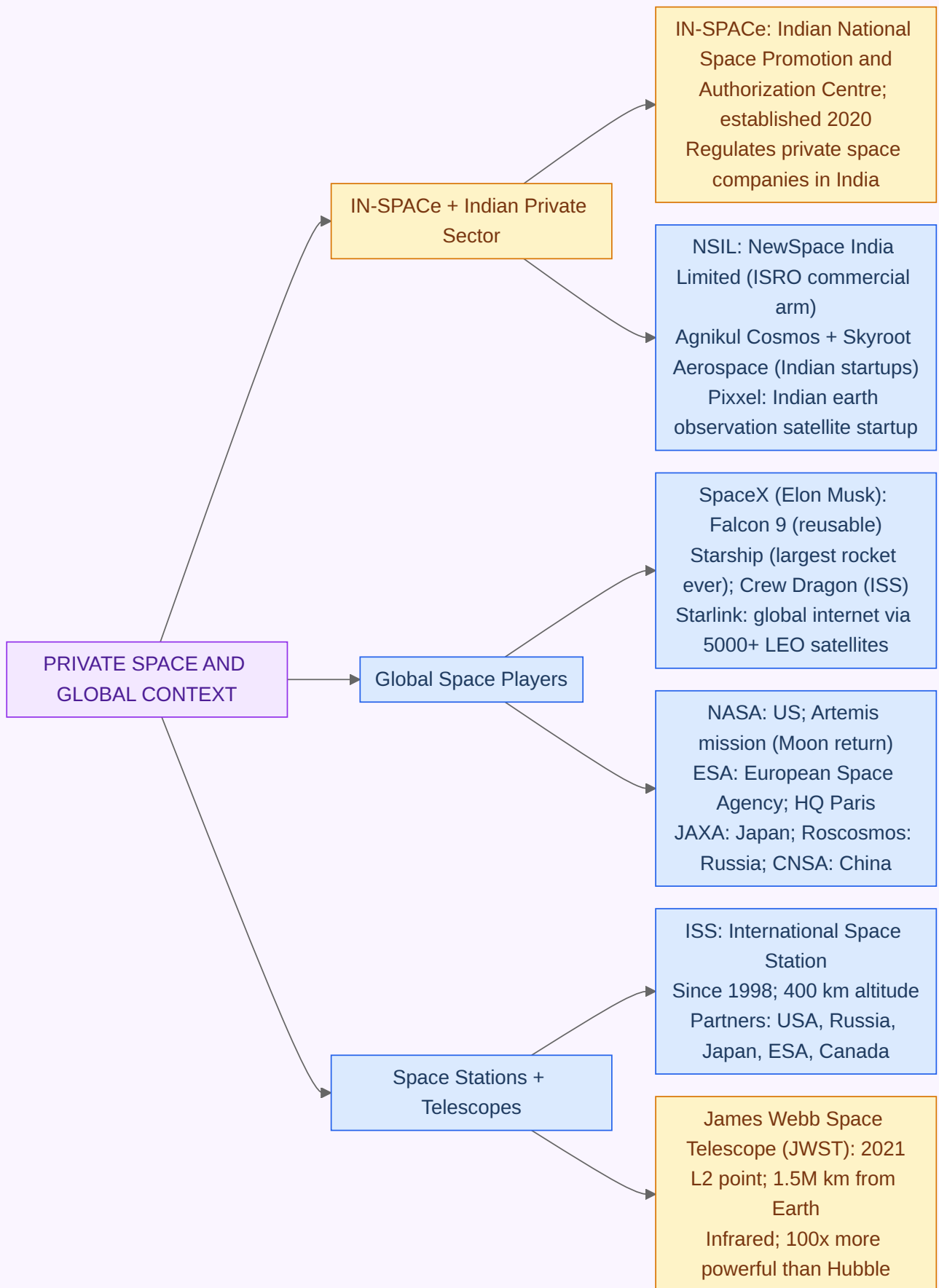
- **SpaceX (USA)** — Falcon 9 reusable, Starship.
- **NASA's Artemis** — return humans to Moon (Artemis III target ~2026).
- **China** — Tiangong station, Chang'e sample returns, Tianwen-1 Mars.
- **ESA** — Ariane 6, JUICE to Jupiter.
- **Russia** — Luna-25 crashed on Moon (Aug 2023, two days before Chandrayaan-3 landed).

Exam pointers

- "India's 1st private rocket?" → **Vikram-S (Skyroot, 18 Nov 2022, sub-orbital)**.
- "Nodal body for private space?" → **IN-SPACe**.
- "Commercial arm of ISRO?" → **NSIL**.

PART B — DEFENCE TECHNOLOGY: GUARDING THE NATION

CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter B1 — DRDO and the Missile Story

Background

1983, Hyderabad. Dr A.P.J. Abdul Kalam, then DRDO Director, pitches the **Integrated Guided Missile Development Programme (IGMDP)** to PM Indira Gandhi. Five missiles, one indigenous project, decades of sanctions. The programme officially concludes in 2008 — having delivered every promised system and birthing India's strategic shield.

IGMDP — the original five

Missile	Type	Range
Prithvi	Surface-to-Surface (short range)	150-350 km
Agni	Surface-to-Surface (medium → ICBM)	700 → 5000+ km
Trishul	Short-range SAM	9 km
Akash	Medium-range SAM	25-45 km
Nag	Anti-tank	4-20 km

Mnemonic: **PATAN** = **P**rithvi, **A**gni, **T**rishul, **A**kash, **N**ag.

Agni Series Ladder

Variant	Range	Notes
Agni-I	700 km	Single-stage, solid fuel
Agni-II	2000 km	Two-stage
Agni-III	3500 km	Reaches deep into China
Agni-IV	4000 km	Road-mobile
Agni-V	5000+ km	ICBM class, canister-launched
Agni-P (Prime)	1000-2000 km	Next-gen replacing Agni-I/II
Agni-V MIRV (2024)	5000+ km	"Mission Divyastra" — first Indian MIRV test

BrahMos — The Speed Demon

- Indo-Russian joint venture (India + Russia; named after **Brahmaputra** + **Moskva**).
- **Supersonic cruise missile**, Mach 2.8-3.0.
- Fired from land, ship, submarine, and air (Su-30MKI).
- **BrahMos-II / Hypersonic version** in development (Mach 7+).
- **First export** (Jan 2022): to **Philippines** (\$375 mn deal).

KEY FACT

Mnemonic — BrahMos: **Brahmaputra** (India's river) + **Moskva** (Moscow, Russia's river) = Indo-Russian joint venture. The name literally encodes the partnership. Similarly remember: BrahMos is developed by **BrahMos Aerospace**, a JV — NOT DRDO alone, NOT ISRO, NOT BARC.

⚠ TRAP — DRDO vs ISRO vs BARC: which body handles what?

Body	Full form	HQ	Focus
ISRO	Indian Space Research Organisation	Bengaluru	Civilian space — satellites, rockets, planetary missions
DRDO	Defence Research & Development Organisation	New Delhi	Military technology — missiles, aircraft, submarines, armour
BARC	Bhabha Atomic Research Centre	Mumbai (Trombay)	Nuclear research — reactors, isotopes, radiological safety
DAE	Department of Atomic Energy	Mumbai	Oversees BARC, NPCIL, nuclear power policy

Common wrong answers: students say "ISRO made BrahMos" (wrong — DRDO + Russia JV); "DRDO runs nuclear reactors" (wrong — NPCIL under DAE); "BARC launches satellites" (wrong — that is ISRO). The division is: **Space = ISRO, Defence = DRDO, Nuclear = BARC/DAE**.

🛡 Air-defence & BMD

- **Akash-NG** — next-gen Akash.
- **QRSAM** — Quick-Reaction SAM.
- **Barak-8** — long-range naval SAM (Indo-Israeli).
- **BMD (Ballistic Missile Defence)**: two-tier — **PAD/PDV (exoatmospheric)** + **AAD (endoatmospheric)**.
- **Mission Shakti** (27 Mar 2019): ASAT test — India became **4th country** with ASAT capability.

Memory aid: "The Missile Shed"

Visualise walking into a large shed at DRDO's Chandipur range. Five doors labelled **P-A-T-A-N**:

1. **Prithvi** door — short-range green crate.
2. **Agni** door — ladder inside with rungs I→V→P→MIRV.
3. **Trishul** door — three prongs (SAM, short range).
4. **Akash** door — sky-blue crate (SAM, medium).
5. **Nag** door — anti-tank teeth.

Then an annex: **BrahMos** in a red-white-blue Russo-Indian crate, **Shakti** (ASAT) banner on the ceiling.

✈ Aeronautics — LCA, AMCA, Drones

- **LCA Tejas (HAL)** — indigenous 4.5-gen fighter. Mk-1A under induction. Mk-2 planned.
- **AMCA** — Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft (5th-gen stealth, in development).
- **HAL Prachand** (formerly LCH) — Light Combat Helicopter, high-altitude specialist.
- **Dhruv & Rudra** — Advanced Light Helicopter family.
- **UAVs**: Nishant, Lakshya (target drone), **Rustom-II/TAPAS** (MALE), **Archer** (armed).

⚓ Naval Programme

- **INS Vikrant** (commissioned Sep 2022) — India's **first indigenous aircraft carrier**.

- **INS Arihant-class** — SSBN (nuclear ballistic subs); Arihant (2016), Arighaat (2024).
- **Project 75 (Scorpene)** — Kalvari-class submarines.
- **Project 75-I, 17A (Nilgiri-class frigates), P-15B Visakhapatnam-class destroyers.**

Army Programme

- **Arjun Mk-1A** — indigenous MBT.
- **K9 Vajra** — 155mm self-propelled howitzer.
- **Dhanush** — indigenised Bofors.
- **Pinaka** — multi-barrel rocket launcher.
- **ATAGS** — Advanced Towed Artillery Gun System (DRDO).

Exam pointers

- "IGMDP — five original missiles?" → **Prithvi, Agni, Trishul, Akash, Nag (PATAN).**
- "BrahMos named after?" → **Brahmaputra + Moskva.**
- "India's ASAT test?" → **Mission Shakti, 27 Mar 2019.**
- "First indigenous aircraft carrier?" → **INS Vikrant (2022).**
- "Agni-V MIRV mission name?" → **Mission Divyastra (2024).**
- "First BrahMos export customer?" → **Philippines (2022).**

In simple words

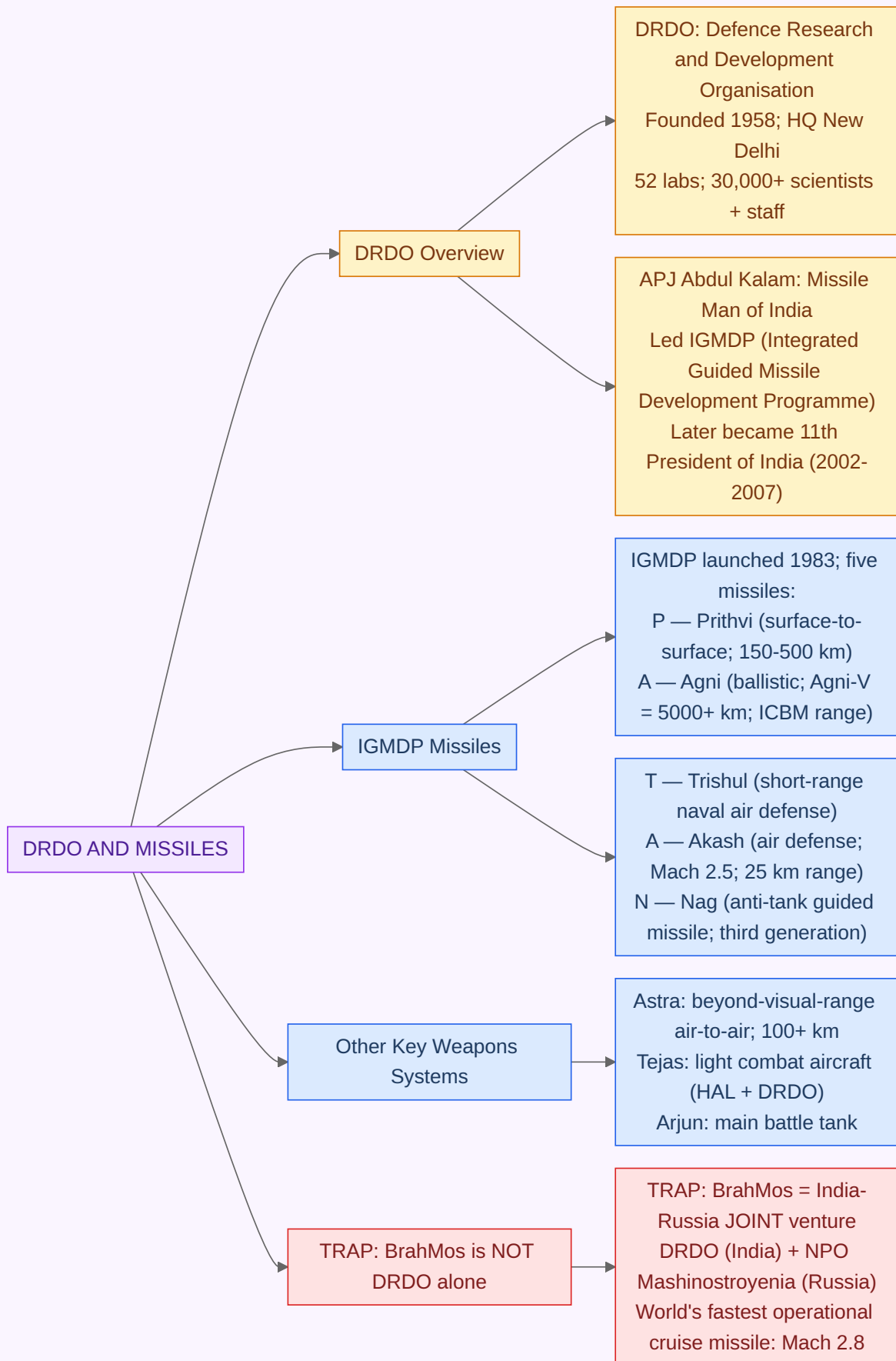
Imagine India has three shields: **Prithvi** for neighbours up close, **Agni** for threats far away, and **Akash/BrahMos** to shoot things *coming at us* out of the sky. Behind the shields stand **Tejas** planes, **Arihant** submarines, **Vikrant** aircraft carriers. Everything was designed here, under sanctions — which is why *indigenisation* is the single word DRDO repeats.

Practice

1. List PATAN and one salient fact about each.
2. Why is Agni-P considered "next-gen" compared to Agni-I?
3. Compare BrahMos and Tomahawk (speed, cost, range). Why is supersonic an advantage?

PART C — NUCLEAR PROGRAMME

CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW

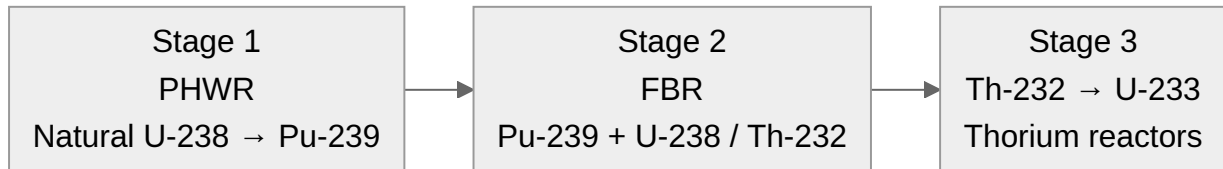


Chapter C1 — Bhabha's Three-Stage Plan

Background

1954, Mumbai. Homi Bhabha founds the Department of Atomic Energy (DAE). His vision: India, blessed with little uranium but mountains of thorium (~25% of world reserves), will build a **three-stage programme** that turns thorium into fuel by mid-century.

The Three Stages



- **Stage 1** — Pressurised Heavy Water Reactors (PHWR) use natural uranium, moderated by heavy water (D_2O). 18 reactors of this type operate in India.
- **Stage 2** — Fast Breeder Reactors (FBR) use plutonium from stage 1, "breeding" more fuel. **PFBR at Kalpakkam** reached criticality in 2024.
- **Stage 3** — Thorium-based Advanced Heavy Water Reactors (AHWR) — still under design.

☢️ Key Nuclear Tests

- **Pokhran-I** (18 May 1974) — Operation **Smiling Buddha**, "peaceful nuclear explosion".
- **Pokhran-II** (11-13 May 1998) — Operation **Shakti**, 5 tests; India declared a nuclear-weapon state. **May 11 → National Technology Day**.

🏢 Organisations under DAE

- **BARC** (Bhabha Atomic Research Centre) — Mumbai.
- **IGCAR** (Indira Gandhi Centre for Atomic Research) — Kalpakkam.
- **NPCIL** (Nuclear Power Corporation of India Ltd) — operates reactors.
- **AERB** (Atomic Energy Regulatory Board) — safety regulator.
- **BHAVINI** — FBR operator.

🔋 Nuclear Power Capacity (Apr 2026)

- **~7.5 GW** installed (target: 22.4 GW by 2031).
- Major sites: Tarapur (first, 1969), Kaiga, Kakrapar, Kudankulam (Russian VVER), Rawatbhata, Narora, Kalpakkam.
- **Nuclear Liability Act 2010** — controversial "right of recourse" to suppliers.
- **India-US 123 Agreement** (2008) — ended nuclear isolation; enabled NSG waiver.

Exam pointers

- "Three stages?" → **PHWR → FBR → Thorium**.
- "Pokhran-II?" → **May 11-13, 1998, Operation Shakti → National Technology Day (May 11)**.
- "India's thorium share?" → **~25% of world reserves (Kerala beach sands)**.
- "Father of Indian atomic programme?" → **Homi Bhabha**.

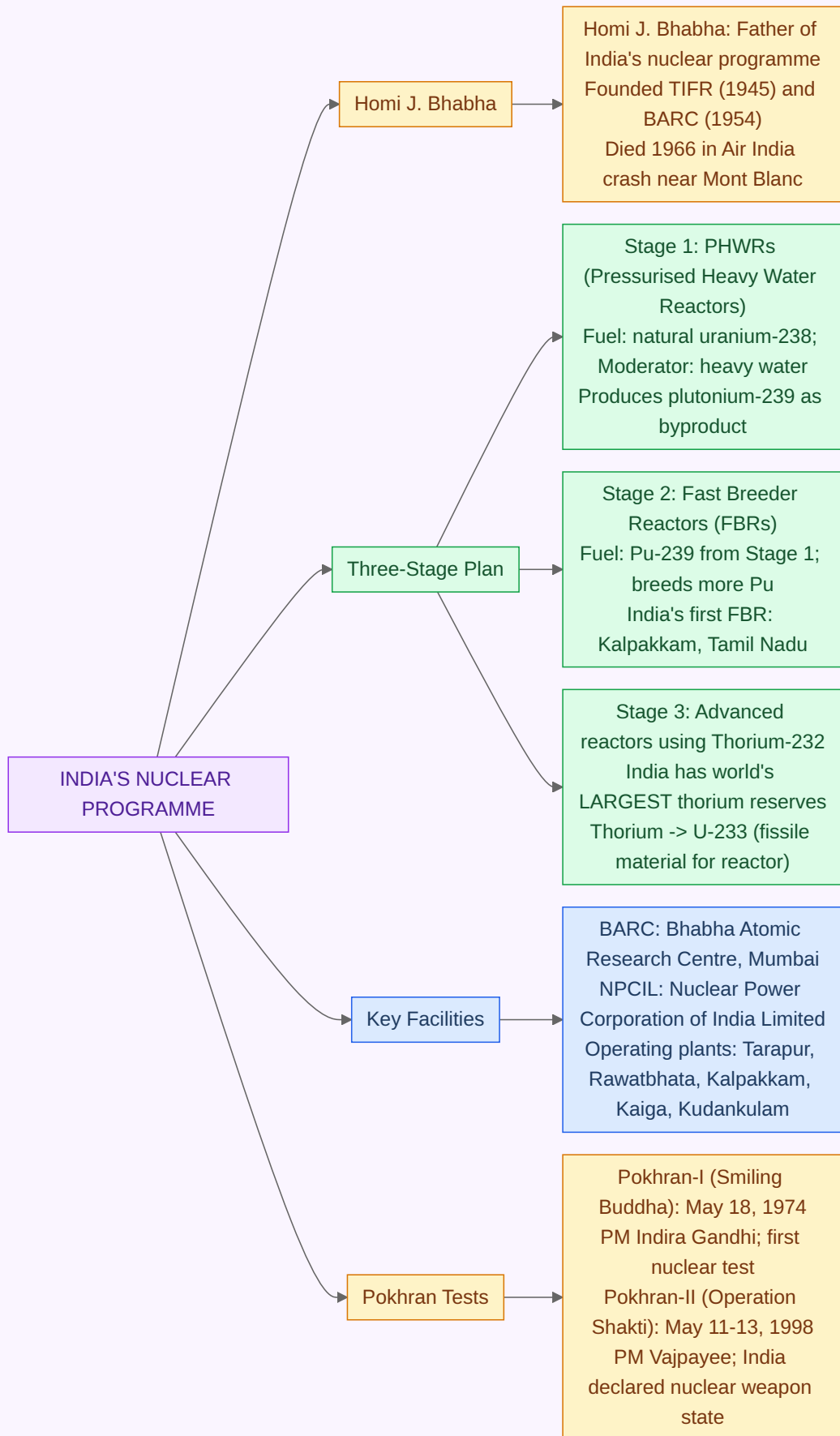
Practice

1. Why does India need a thorium cycle?

2. What is the role of heavy water in PHWR?
3. Name three sites and their reactor types.

PART D — COMPUTING, AI, AND DIGITAL INDIA

© CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW

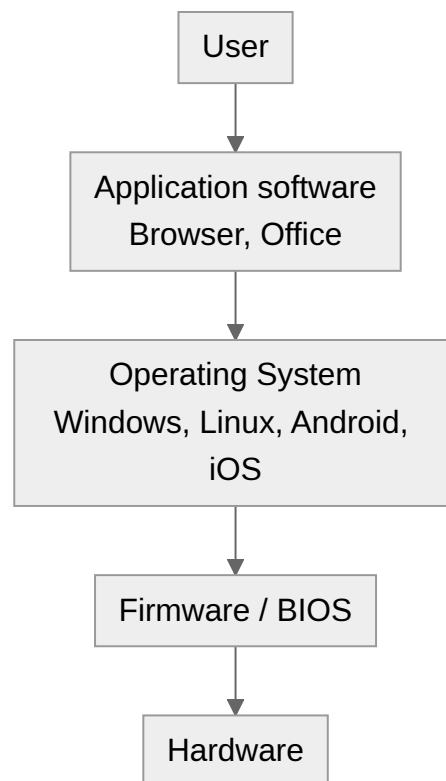


Chapter D1 — Computer Fundamentals

Basic Vocabulary (non-negotiable for SSC/Banking)

- **Hardware** (physical) vs **software** (programs).
- **CPU** = Central Processing Unit = **brain** (ALU + Control Unit + Registers).
- **RAM** (volatile, fast) vs **ROM** (non-volatile, fixed).
- **Primary storage** (RAM, cache) vs **secondary** (HDD, SSD, USB).
- **Bit** → **Byte** (8 bits) → **KB (1024 B)** → **MB** → **GB** → **TB** → **PB**.
- **Motherboard** connects everything.
- **GPU** — graphics processor (parallel, heavy in AI now).

Software Layers



Networking

- **LAN** → **MAN** → **WAN** (scale ladder).
- **IP v4 (32-bit)** vs **IP v6 (128-bit)**.
- **TCP/IP** — reliable transport.
- **HTTP/HTTPS** — web.
- **DNS** — name → IP.
- **OSI model** — 7 layers (Physical, Data link, Network, Transport, Session, Presentation, Application).
Mnemonic: **Please Do Not Throw Sausage Pizza Away**.

Malware Zoo

- **Virus** — attaches to files, needs user execution.
- **Worm** — self-replicating over networks.

- **Trojan** — disguised.
- **Ransomware** — encrypts & demands payment (**WannaCry** 2017).
- **Spyware / Adware / Rootkit / Keylogger**.
- **Phishing / Smishing / Vishing** — social engineering.

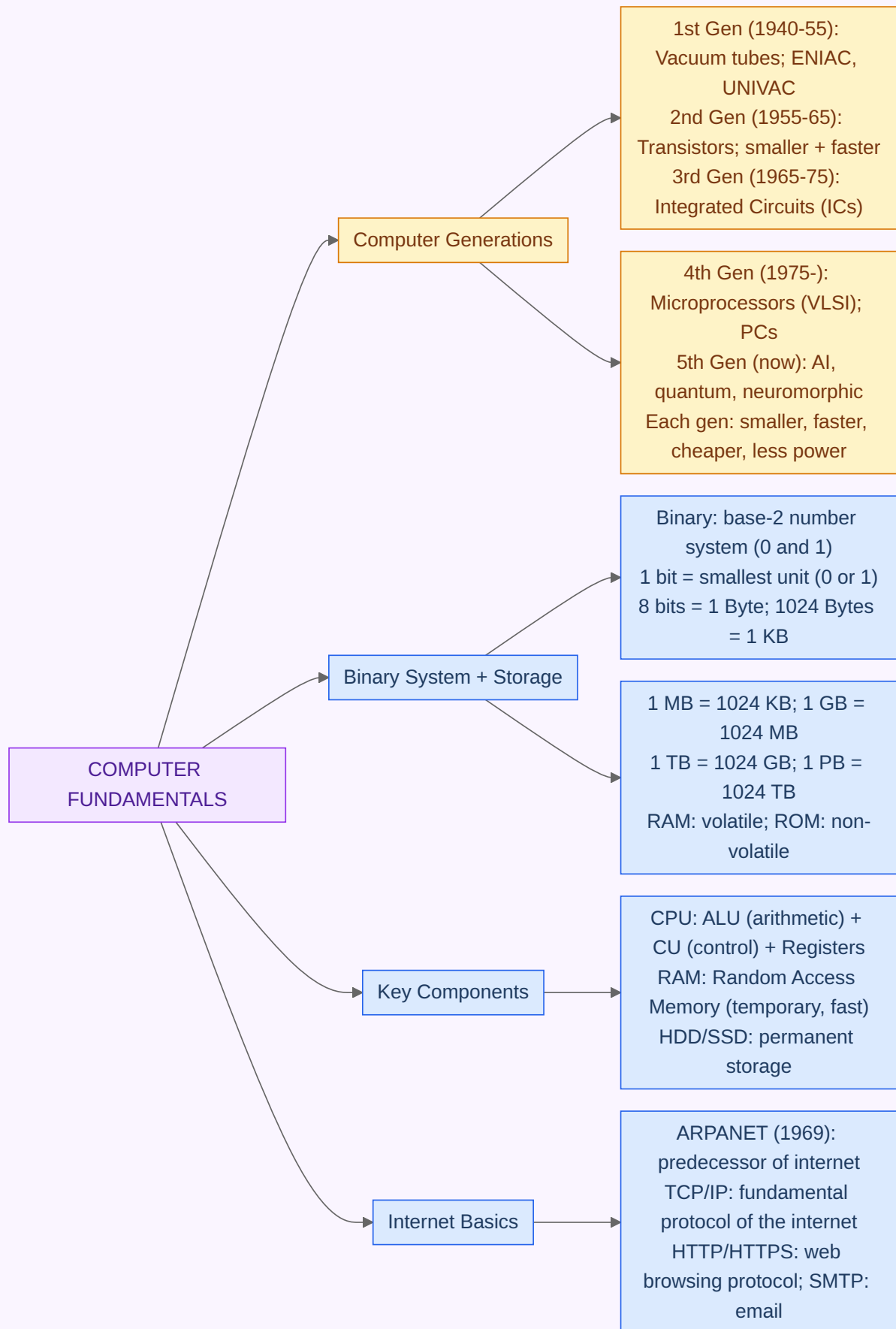
Cryptography Primer

- **Symmetric** (AES) vs **asymmetric** (RSA, ECC) keys.
- **Hash functions** — SHA-256, MD5 (broken).
- **Digital signature** = hash + private-key encryption.
- **TLS/SSL** — secures HTTP → HTTPS.
- **Blockchain** — chained blocks of hashes (Bitcoin 2009 by Satoshi Nakamoto).

Exam pointers

- "1 KB = ?" → **1024 bytes**. (Some contexts: 1000.)
- "OSI layers count?" → **7**.
- "Father of computers?" → **Charles Babbage (Difference/Analytical Engine)**.
- "First computer virus?" → **Creeper (1971)**.

CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter D2 — Artificial Intelligence & Emerging Tech

AI Taxonomy

- **Narrow AI** (today — ChatGPT, Alexa, image recognition).
- **AGI** (human-level general intelligence — not yet).
- **ASI** (super-intelligent — speculative).

Key Sub-fields

- **Machine Learning** — learning from data.
- **Supervised** (labelled), **unsupervised** (clustering), **reinforcement** (reward).
- **Deep Learning** — multi-layer neural networks (CNNs for images, RNN/Transformers for sequences).
- **Generative AI** — LLMs (GPT, Claude, Gemini), image models (DALL-E, Midjourney).
- **NLP** — text understanding.
- **Computer Vision** — image/video understanding.
- **Robotics** — physical AI.

India's AI Ecosystem

- **IndiaAI Mission** (Mar 2024): ₹10,371 crore — GPU compute, foundation models, datasets, applications, startups, skilling, safe-and-trusted AI.
- **BHASHINI** — national AI-based language translation platform (22 scheduled languages).
- **AIRAWAT** — AI supercomputer at C-DAC Pune.
- **NITI Aayog's "AI for All" strategy (2018)**.

Other Emerging Tech

- **Blockchain + Web3** — decentralised ledgers. **CBDC (Digital Rupee)** pilot by RBI (2022).
- **Quantum Computing** — **National Quantum Mission** (2023), ₹6,003 cr, 2023-31; targets 1000-qubit computer.
- **IoT (Internet of Things)** — sensor-networks, smart cities.
- **5G** — rolled out Oct 2022 by PM; 6G Vision Document released 2023.
- **Cloud computing** — IaaS/PaaS/SaaS; MeghRaj (Govt cloud).
- **Digital Twin** — virtual replica for simulation.

Digital India Programme (2015)

Nine pillars, most-quoted flagships:

- **UIDAI / Aadhaar** (2009).
- **UPI** (2016) — unified payments; **>15 billion transactions/month** in 2026.
- **DigiLocker, eSanjeevani, CoWIN, DIKSHA, UMANG, BHIM, Rupay, ONDC**.
- **Bharat Net / National Broadband** — fibre to every panchayat.
- **PMGDISHA** — rural digital literacy.

Exam pointers

- "UPI operator?" → **NPCI (National Payments Corporation of India)**.
- "IndiaAI budget?" → **₹10,371 crore, approved March 2024**.
- "National Quantum Mission corpus?" → **₹6,003 crore (2023-31)**.

- "BHASHINI covers?" → **22 scheduled Indian languages**.
- "CBDC / Digital Rupee pilot launched?" → **Dec 2022 (retail)**.

In simple words

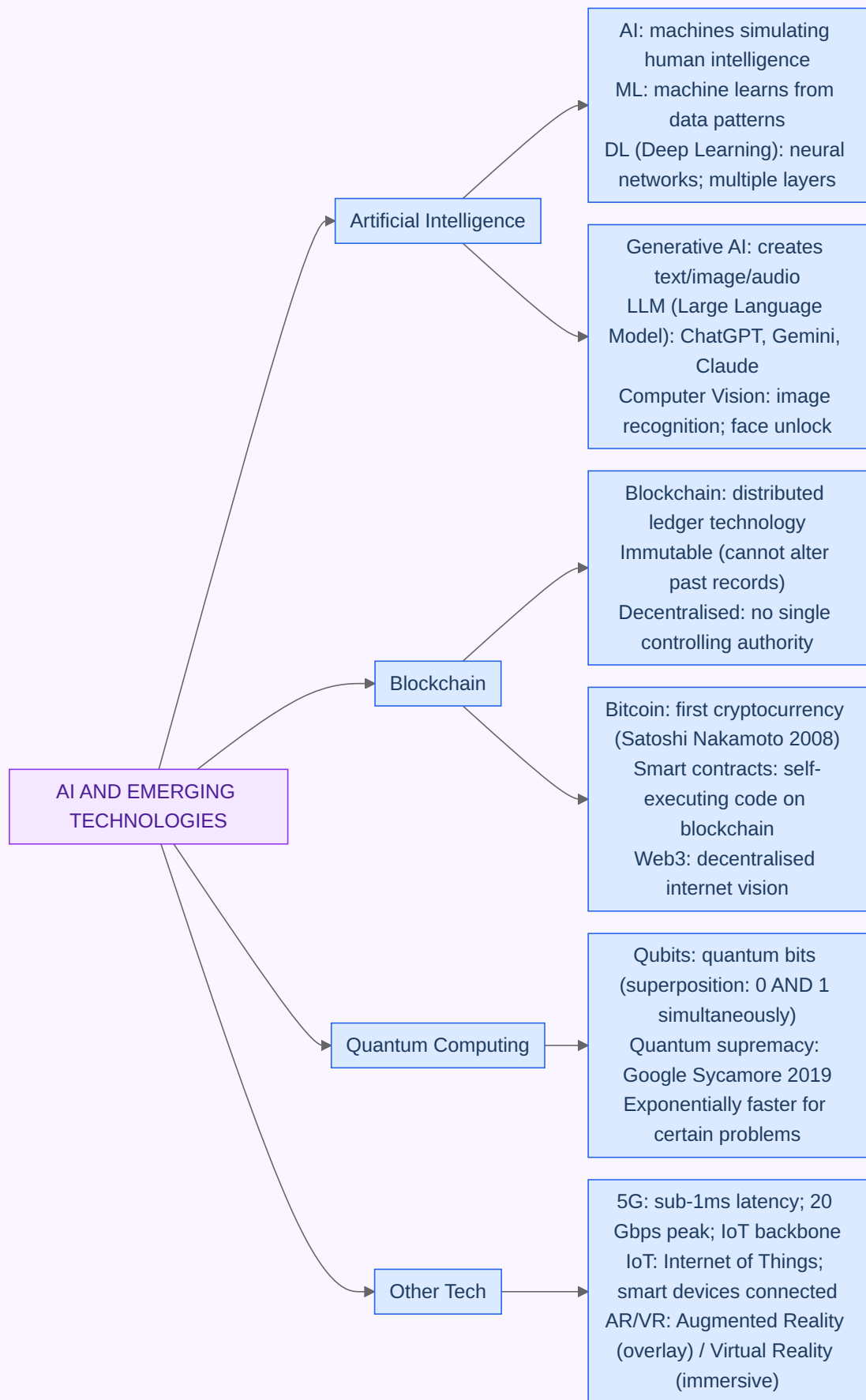
AI today is basically **pattern-matching on steroids**. Feed a machine millions of cat pictures → it learns "cat-ness" and flags new cats. Feed it trillions of words → it learns to predict the next word (that's ChatGPT). No consciousness, no magic — just math + data + GPUs. India's challenge: build our own models in our own languages so we're not renting tech from California.

Practice

1. List 3 differences between Narrow AI and AGI.
2. Explain UPI in a minute; who operates it, what year it launched, who regulates it.
3. What is the National Quantum Mission's budget and target qubit count?

PART E — BIOTECHNOLOGY & HEALTH TECH

© CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter E1 — Genetic Engineering Primer

Core Vocabulary

- **DNA** — double helix, carries hereditary info (A-T, G-C pairs).
- **RNA** — single-strand, transcribed from DNA, translated to protein.
- **Gene** — a DNA segment coding one (or more) protein.
- **Genome** — full DNA set.
- **Genomics** — study of genomes.
- **Proteomics** — study of proteins.

Key Techniques

- **PCR** (Polymerase Chain Reaction) — amplify DNA. Kary Mullis, Nobel 1993. COVID testing workhorse.
- **Recombinant DNA** — cut-paste genes across organisms (enables insulin, hormones).
- **CRISPR-Cas9** — gene-editing "molecular scissors". Charpentier & Doudna, Nobel 2020.
- **Stem cells** — undifferentiated cells (embryonic / adult / iPSC).
- **Cloning** — Dolly the sheep (1996, first mammal).

Vaccines — India's Global Role

- India = **pharmacy of the world** (>60% of world's vaccines by volume).
- **Serum Institute** (Pune) — world's largest by volume.
- **Bharat Biotech** — Covaxin, Rotavac, iNCOVACC (nasal COVID vaccine).
- **COVID-era launches (Jan 2021):**
- **Covishield** (Oxford-AstraZeneca, made by Serum).
- **Covaxin** (Bharat Biotech — India's 1st indigenous COVID vaccine, inactivated virus).
- **ZyCoV-D** (Zydus, world's 1st DNA-plasmid COVID vaccine, needle-free).
- **CoWIN** platform — vaccination registry; open-sourced, used by other countries.

Agri-Biotech

- **Bt cotton** — first GM crop approved in India (2002).
- **Bt brinjal** — GEAC cleared (2010) but moratorium imposed.
- **DMH-11 mustard** (2022 GEAC clearance) — GM mustard, under SC scrutiny.
- **Golden Rice** — Vitamin-A-fortified rice (international).
- **GEAC** (Genetic Engineering Appraisal Committee) — regulator under MoEFCC.

Regulatory Bodies

- **DBT** (Department of Biotechnology) — under MoS&T.
- **BIRAC** — Biotechnology Industry Research Assistance Council (funding agency).
- **NII / NCBS / THSTI / IGIB / inStem / RCB** — flagship biotech labs.
- **ICMR** — medical research apex body.

Exam pointers

- "Bt cotton approved in India?" → **2002 (first GM crop)**.
- "CRISPR Nobel?" → **Charpentier & Doudna, 2020**.
- "Indigenous COVID vaccine?" → **Covaxin (Bharat Biotech)**.

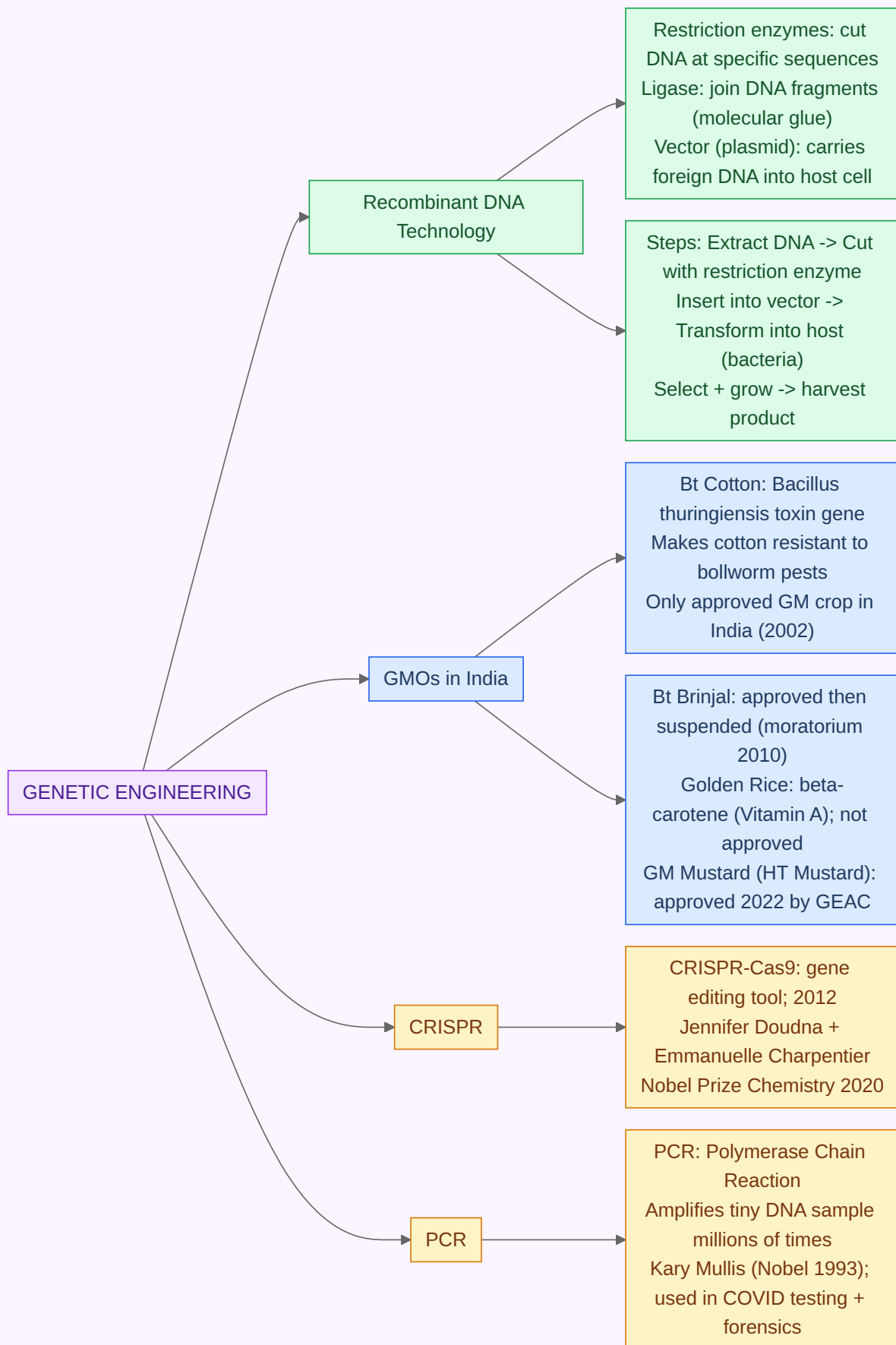
- "World's 1st DNA-plasmid COVID vaccine?" → **ZyCoV-D (Zydus, India)**.
- "GM mustard = ?" → **DMH-11**.

Practice

1. Trace insulin production: from gene to product, using recombinant DNA.
2. Why is CRISPR a revolution over older gene-editing methods?
3. List three indigenous vaccines developed by Bharat Biotech.

PART F — ENERGY & ENVIRONMENT TECH

🕒 CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter F1 — India's Energy Transition

☀ Renewable Milestones (Apr 2026)

- **Installed power capacity:** ~450 GW.
- **Non-fossil share:** ~47% (target 50% by 2030).
- **Solar:** ~93 GW.
- **Wind:** ~46 GW.
- **Large hydro:** ~47 GW.
- **Nuclear:** ~7.5 GW.

Paris Pledges (NDCs, updated 2022)

1. 50% non-fossil capacity by 2030.
2. Reduce emissions intensity of GDP by 45% (from 2005 levels) by 2030.
3. Additional **2.5-3 billion tonnes CO₂** forest sink by 2030.
4. **Net-Zero by 2070** (Glasgow COP26).

🚀 Key Missions

- **International Solar Alliance** (2015, with France) — 100+ members.
- **ISA Summit 2018**, HQ Gurugram.
- **PM-KUSUM** — solar pumps for farmers.
- **PLI Scheme** — solar modules, batteries.
- **National Green Hydrogen Mission** (Jan 2023, ₹19,744 cr) — target 5 MMT green hydrogen by 2030.
- **National Electric Mobility Mission (NEMMP) + FAME-I & II.**

⚡ Grid & Transmission

- **One Nation One Grid** achieved 2013 (Southern grid synced).
- **POSOCO → Grid Controller of India Ltd.**
- **Green energy open access rules 2022** — simpler RE procurement.

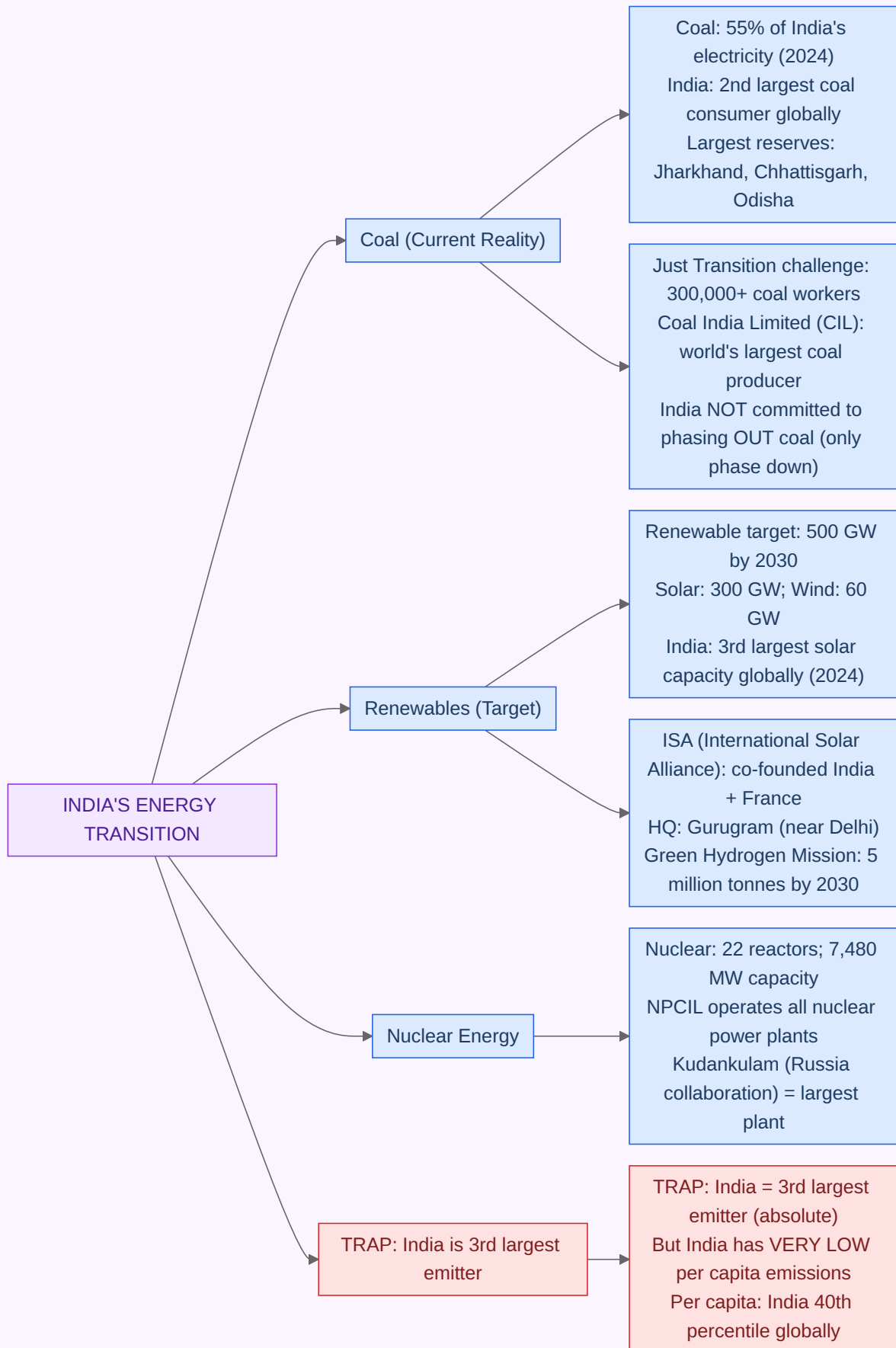
Exam pointers

- "India's net-zero target?" → **2070.**
- "ISA HQ?" → **Gurugram (Haryana).**
- "National Green Hydrogen Mission outlay?" → **₹19,744 crore.**
- "Non-fossil share target 2030?" → **50% installed capacity.**

Practice

1. What are India's four NDC targets?
2. Why is green hydrogen called "green" vs grey/blue?
3. Name three flagship solar schemes.

PART G — HEALTH & MEDICAL TECH



Chapter G1 — Medical Missions & Innovations

Key Programmes

- **Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY** (2018) — world's largest public health insurance (₹5 lakh/family/year; 55 crore beneficiaries).
- **Ayushman Bharat Digital Mission (ABDM)** — ABHA health ID; health records stack.
- **Mission Indradhanush** — universal immunisation for children & pregnant women.
- **eSanjeevani** — national telemedicine; 10+ crore consultations.
- **CoWIN** — COVID vaccination backbone.
- **PMBJP** — Jan Aushadhi Pariyojana (generic medicines).
- **PM-ABHIM** — PM Ayushman Bharat Health Infrastructure Mission (₹64,180 cr).

Indigenous Innovations

- **Indian HPV vaccine (CERVAVAC)** — Sep 2022, Serum Institute.
- **inCOVACC** — intranasal COVID booster (world's first).
- **Polio eradication certification** — India declared polio-free in 2014 by WHO.
- **Tele-MANAS** — National Tele Mental Health Programme (2022).

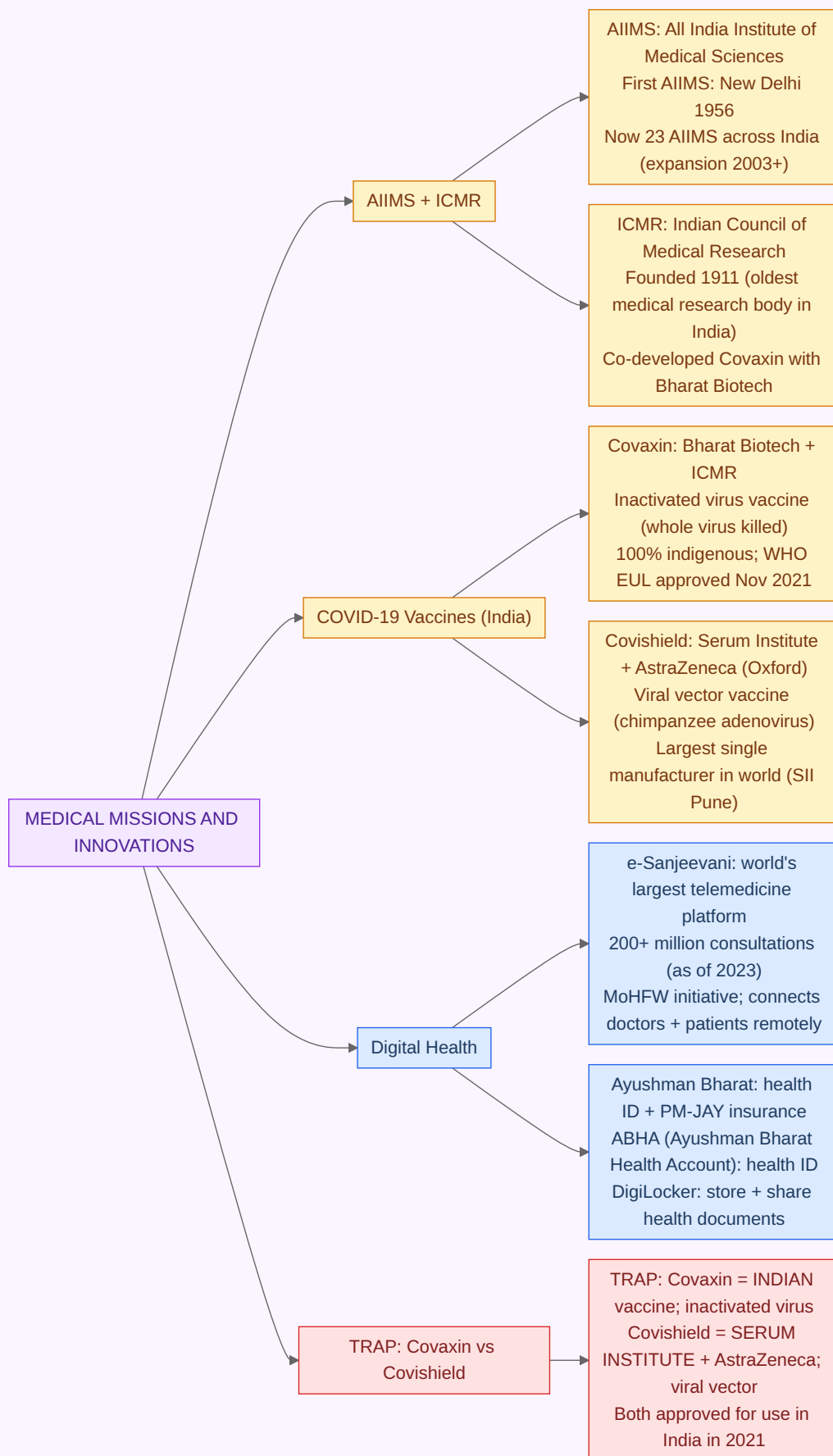
Exam pointers

- "PM-JAY coverage?" → **₹5 lakh/family/year**.
- "World's 1st intranasal COVID vaccine?" → **inCOVACC**.
- "India declared polio-free?" → **2014**.
- "Indigenous HPV vaccine?" → **CERVAVAC (2022)**.

PART H — PHYSICS, CHEMISTRY, BIOLOGY ESSENTIALS

Physics, Chemistry, and Biology each have dedicated full-length books in this series. This part provides a rapid-revision layer for the general-awareness flavour of questions that appear in SSC and Banking exams.

⦿ CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW

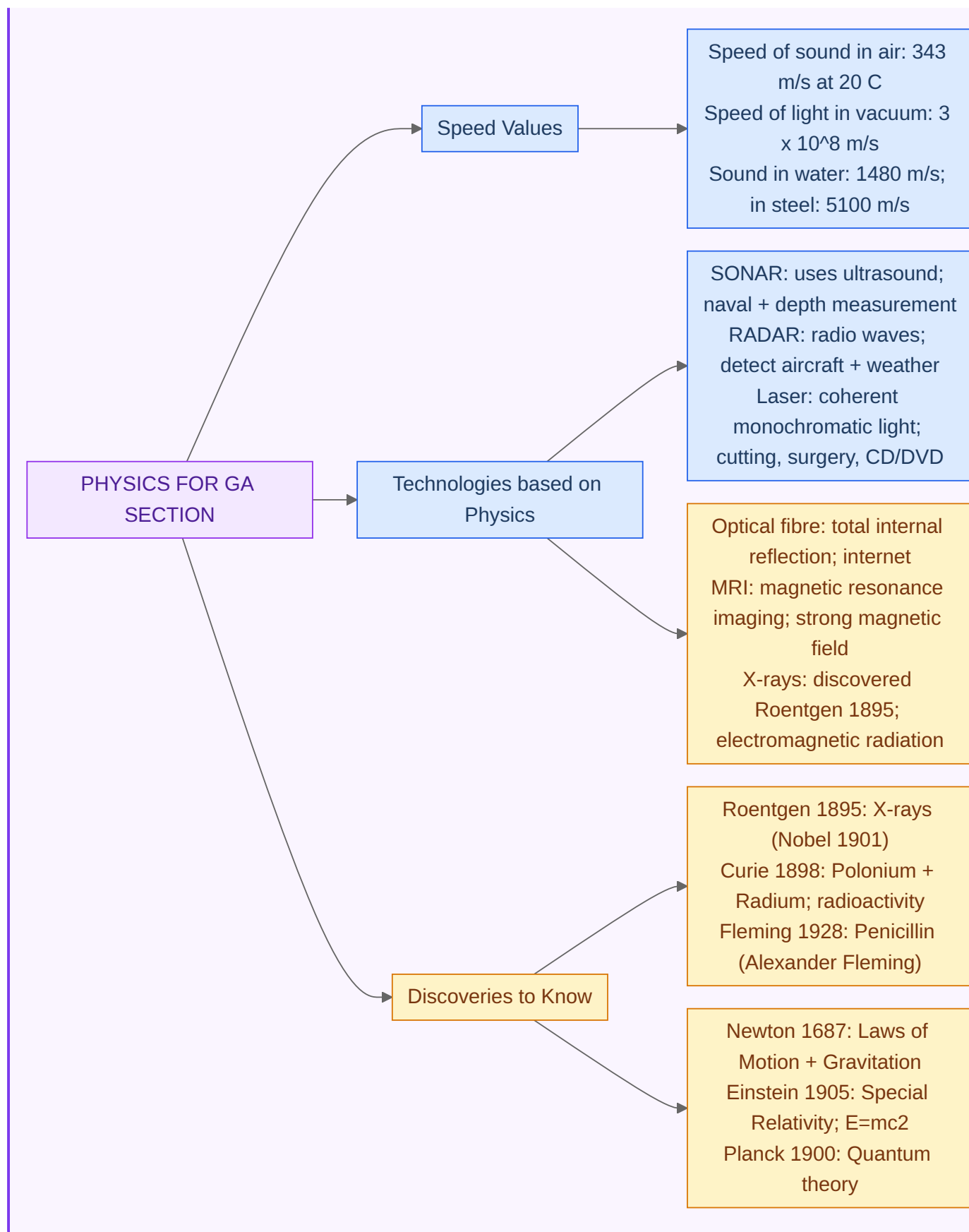


Chapter H1 — Physics Essentials (General Awareness flavour)

- **SI units** — 7 base: m, kg, s, A, K, mol, cd.

- **Laws of Motion** (Newton) — 1st (inertia), 2nd ($F = ma$), 3rd (action-reaction).
- **Laws of Thermodynamics** — 0th (thermal equilibrium), 1st (energy conservation), 2nd (entropy), 3rd (absolute zero unreachable).
- **Electromagnetic spectrum** (low → high frequency): **Radio → Microwave → Infrared → Visible → UV → X-rays → Gamma**.
- **Visible light (VIBGYOR)** — 380-750 nm.
- **Speed of light in vacuum** — 3×10^8 m/s.
- **Sound** — longitudinal, ~343 m/s in air, ~1500 m/s in water, faster in solids.
- **LASER** — Light Amplification by Stimulated Emission of Radiation.

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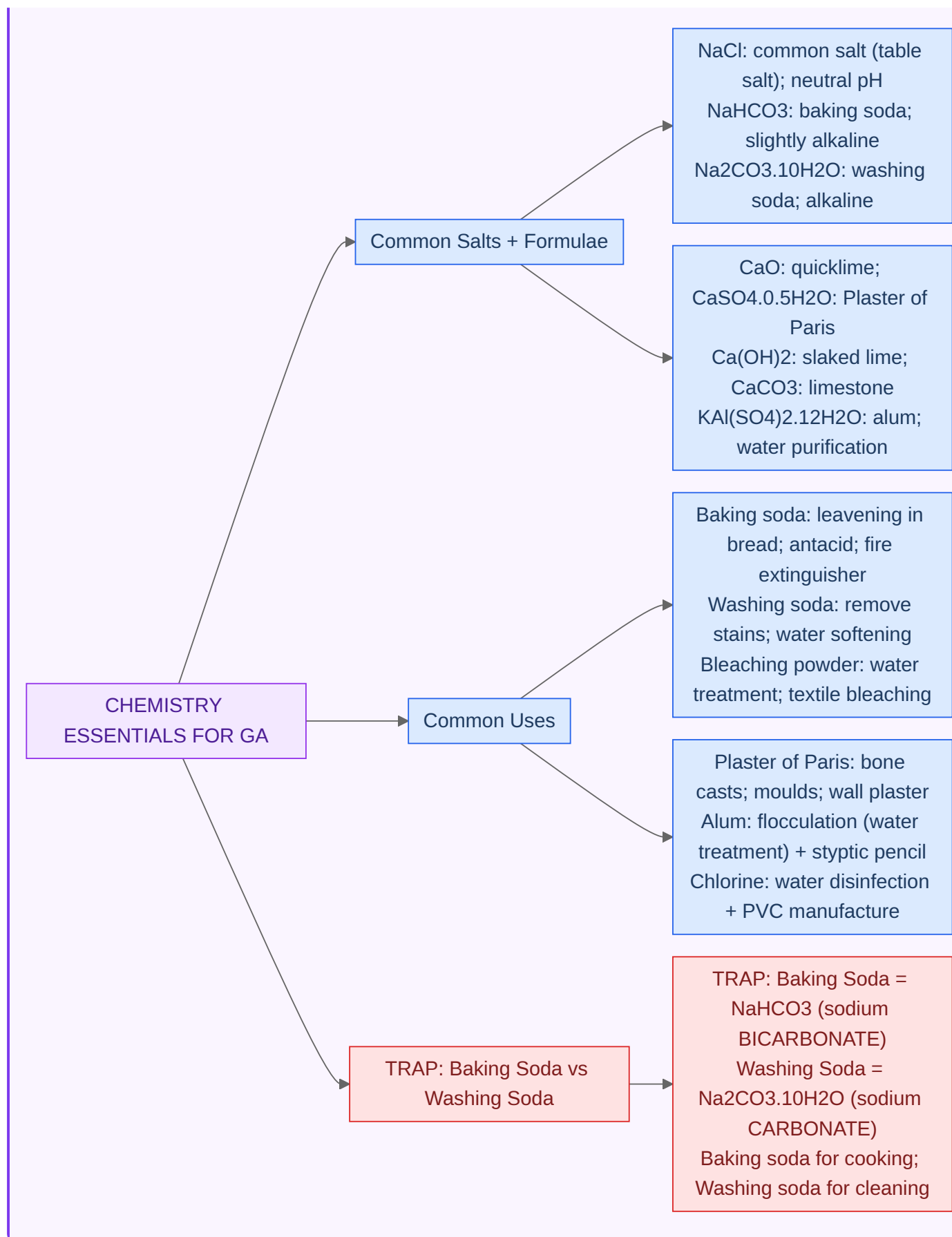


Chapter H2 — Chemistry Essentials

- **Periodic Table** — 118 elements; **Mendeleev** (1869) → modern by Moseley (atomic number).
- **S-block, p-block, d-block (transition), f-block (lanthanides+actinides).**
- **Atomic structure** — Dalton → Thomson (plum pudding) → Rutherford → Bohr → Quantum.

- **Acids/Bases** — Arrhenius, Brønsted-Lowry, Lewis.
- **pH** — 0-14; < 7 acid, > 7 base.
- **Key gases & uses:** O₂ (respiration), CO₂ (photosynthesis/fire-ext), N₂ (fertiliser, inert), H₂ (fuel of future), He (balloons), Ne (sign lights), Ar (bulb filling).

🕒 CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW



Chapter H3 — Biology Essentials

- **Cell** = basic unit of life.
- **Prokaryote** (no nucleus — bacteria) vs **Eukaryote** (plants, animals, fungi, protists).

- **Five kingdoms** (Whittaker 1969): Monera, Protista, Fungi, Plantae, Animalia.
- **11 human systems** — integumentary, skeletal, muscular, nervous, endocrine, cardiovascular, lymphatic, respiratory, digestive, urinary, reproductive.
- **Blood groups** — A, B, AB, O × Rh+/- . AB+ universal recipient, O- universal donor.
- **Vitamins deficiency:** A (night blindness), B₁ (beriberi), B₃ (pellagra), B₁₂ (anaemia), C (scurvy), D (rickets), E (sterility), K (bleeding).

 *For depth, jump to the dedicated subject books.*

APPENDICES

© CHAPTER SUMMARY — EVERYTHING IN ONE VIEW

**BIOLOGY ESSENTIALS
FOR GA**

Human Body Key Numbers

Bones in adult: 206; Bones
in infant: 270-300
Smallest bone: Stapes
(ear); Largest: Femur
Normal pulse: 72 bpm; BP:
120/80 mmHg

Body temperature: 37 C;
pH of blood: 7.35-7.45
RBC lifespan: 120 days;
WBC: days-years
Platelet lifespan: 10 days

Blood Facts

Universal donor: O
negative (O-)
Universal recipient: AB
positive (AB+)
Landsteiner discovered
ABO system 1901 (Nobel
1930)

**Disease Vectors — Quick
Reference**

Malaria: Plasmodium via
Anopheles female mosquito
Dengue: Flavivirus via
Aedes aegypti mosquito
Filariasis: Wuchereria
bancrofti via Culex
mosquito

Sleeping sickness:
Trypanosoma via Tsetse fly
Plague: Yersinia pestis via
rat flea
Kala-azar: Leishmania via
sandfly

**Vitamins — Quick
Reference**

A: Night blindness; B1:
Beriberi; B3: Pellagra
B12: Pernicious anaemia;
C: Scurvy
D: Rickets; K: Poor clotting

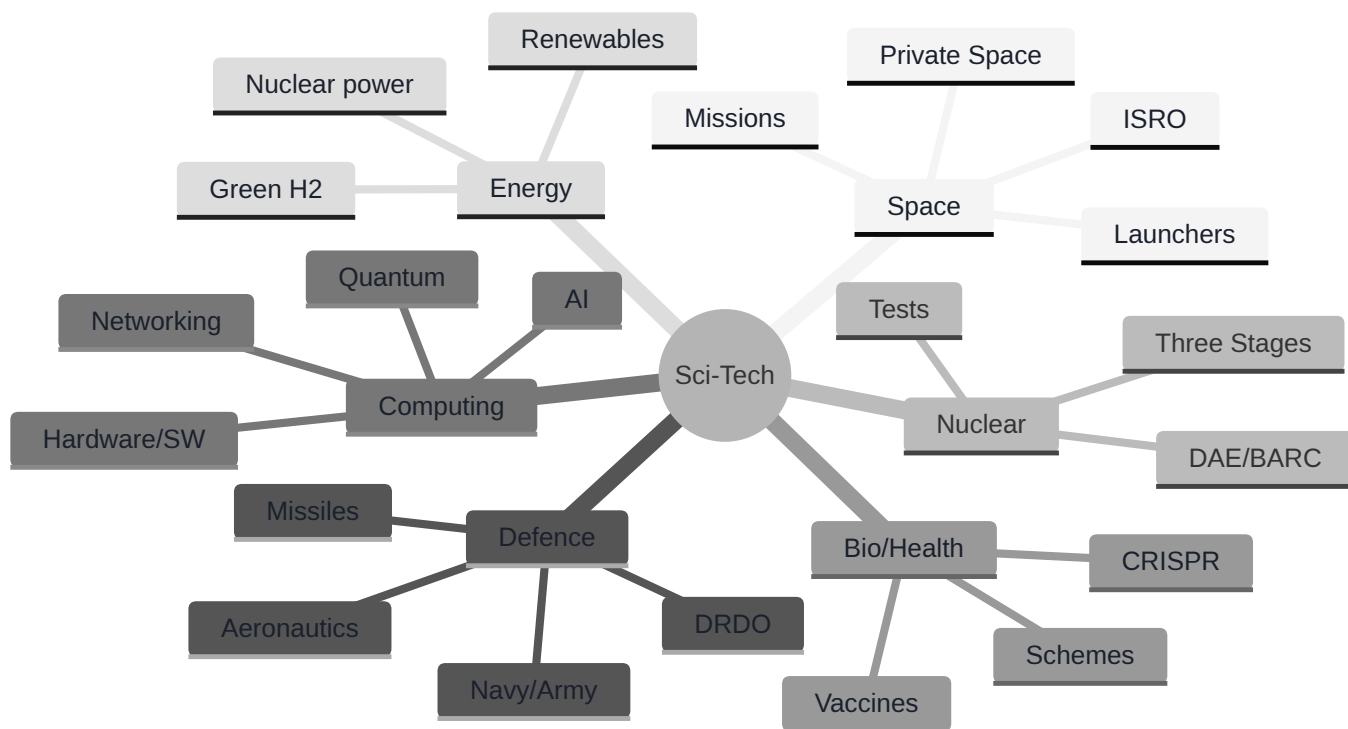
Appendix 1 — One-page cheatsheet

Category	Key Fact
ISRO HQ	Bengaluru
DRDO HQ	New Delhi
DAE HQ	Mumbai
AEC/BARC	Mumbai
PSLV record	104 sats (2017)
Chandrayaan - 3 landing	23 Aug 2023
National Space Day	23 August
National Technology Day	11 May
Mission Shakti (ASAT)	27 Mar 2019
INS Vikrant	Commissioned Sep 2022
Agni-V MIRV	Mission Divyastra, 2024
First indigenous COVID vaccine	Covaxin
Nuclear 3-stage	PHWR → FBR → Thorium
Net-zero year	2070
IndiaAI Mission corpus	₹10,371 cr
NQM corpus	₹6,003 cr (2023-31)

Appendix 2 — Master Mnemonics List

- **PATAN** → Prithvi-Agni-Trishul-Akash-Nag (IGMDP).
- **Launchpad Walk** → SSLV-PSLV-GSLV-LVM3-Gaganyaan.
- **PDNTSPA** (Please Do Not Throw Sausage Pizza Away) → OSI 7 layers.
- **VIBGYOR** → Violet-Indigo-Blue-Green-Yellow-Orange-Red.

Appendix 3 — Mind Map (Sci-Tech)



PART X — RECENT ISRO MISSIONS (2020-2026)

Year	Mission	Launcher	Notes
2019 (Jul)	Chandrayaan - 2	GSLV Mk-III M1	Orbiter, Vikram lander (crashed), Pragyan rover
2020 (Nov)	EOS-01 (RISAT-2BR2)	PSLV-C49	radar imaging
2021 (Feb)	Amazonia-1 (Brazil) + 18 co-passengers	PSLV-C51	first dedicated commercial PSLV under NSIL
2022 (Aug)	SSLV-D1 (maiden flight)	SSLV (1st)	EOS-02 partial failure
2022 (Oct)	OneWeb 36 satellites	LVM3 (rebranded GSLV Mk-III)	first commercial LVM3
2023 (Mar)	OneWeb 36 satellites (2nd batch)	LVM3	
2023 (Jul)	Chandrayaan - 3	LVM3 M4	soft landing 23 Aug 2023 at Shiv Shakti Point near south pole — India 4th country (after USA, USSR, China); 1st to land near lunar south pole
2023 (Sep)	Aditya-L1	PSLV-C57	India's 1st solar mission; placed at Lagrange-1 in Jan 2024
2023 (Oct)	Gaganyaan TV-D1	Test Vehicle	crew-escape test (in-flight abort)
2024 (Jan)	XPoSat (X-ray Polarimeter Satellite)	PSLV-C58	studies cosmic X-ray polarisation
2024 (Feb)	INSAT-3DS	GSLV F14	weather + meteorology
2024 (Aug)	EOS-08	SSLV-D3	3rd & final SSLV development flight; SSLV now operational
2024 (30 Dec)	SpaDeX (Space Docking Experiment)	PSLV-C60	India's 1st space-docking mission, docking achieved 16 Jan 2025 — 4th country (after USA, Russia, China)
2025 (Jul)	NISAR (NASA-ISRO SAR) — launched 30 Jul 2025	GSLV-F16	joint Earth-observation Synthetic Aperture Radar mission
2026 (H2)	Gaganyaan - 1 (uncrewed) — Vyommitra robot onboard	LVM3	First uncrewed orbital test (delayed from 2025); will simulate full human spaceflight profile
2027 (H1)	Gaganyaan crewed mission (G2 + G3 uncrewed first)	LVM3	India's first human spaceflight

Year	Mission	Launcher	Notes
2026-28 (planned)	Chandrayaan-4	LVM3 + PSLV (split)	sample-return mission
2028 (planned)	Mangalyaan-2 (MOM-2)	LVM3	second Mars mission
2028 (planned)	Shukrayaan-1 (Venus mission)	LVM3	Venus orbiter
2035 (vision)	Bharatiya Antariksh Station	—	India's space station
2040 (vision)	Indian on Moon	—	crewed lunar mission

ISRO launch vehicle evolution

Vehicle	Years active	Payload to LEO	Notes
SLV-3	1979-83	40 kg	India's first; Rohini satellites
ASLV	1987-94	150 kg	augmented SLV
PSLV	1993-	1,750 kg (sun-sync)	"workhorse"; XL variant carries up to 1.9 t
GSLV Mk-II	2001-	2,500 kg (LEO), 2,200 kg (GTO)	indigenous cryogenic stage
LVM3 (GSLV Mk-III)	2014-	8,000 kg LEO, 4,000 kg GTO	Chandrayaan-2/3, Gaganyaan
SSLV	2022-	500 kg	small-satellite launch; on-demand
Reusable Launch Vehicle (RLV-TD)	2016 (test), 2024 (REX-3)	demonstration	autonomous landing tests
NGLV (Soorya)	2031 (planned)	10-15 t LEO	next-gen heavy-lift, partially reusable

Indian astronauts (Vyomanaut programme)

- **Rakesh Sharma** — first Indian in space (1984) on Soviet Soyuz T-11.
- **Wing Commander Subhash Chandra Pradeep Krishnan Nair (Prashanth Nair), Group Captain Ajit Krishnan, Group Captain Angad Pratap, Wing Commander Shubhanshu Shukla** — Gaganyaan-1 designate astronauts (announced Feb 2024).

PART Y — DEFENCE TECHNOLOGY (recent)

Missiles — operational (DRDO)

Missile	Type	Range
Prithvi-I/II/III	SRBM (surface-to-surface)	150-350 km
Agni-I	SRBM	700 km
Agni-II	MRBM	2,000 km
Agni-III	IRBM	3,500 km
Agni-IV	IRBM	4,000 km
Agni-V	ICBM (with MIRV — Mission Divyastra Mar 2024)	5,000+ km
Agni-Prime (Agni-P)	new-gen MRBM	1,000-2,000 km
Trishul	short-range SAM	9 km (decommissioned)
Akash	medium-range SAM	25-30 km
Akash-NG	new-gen SAM	70-80 km
Nag / Helina	anti-tank	4-7 km
Nag (NAMICA)	vehicle-mounted	7 km
Astra Mk-I/Mk-II/Mk-III	beyond-visual-range air-to-air	110 / 160 / 350 km
Rudram-1	anti-radiation missile	100-250 km
BrahMos	supersonic cruise	290 → 450 → 800 km variants
BrahMos-NG	smaller, lighter variant	290-500 km
BrahMos-II (planned)	hypersonic	1,500 km
K-15 (Sagarika)	SLBM	700 km
K-4	SLBM	3,500 km
K-5 (planned)	SLBM	5,000 km
Pinaka Mk-I/II	multi-barrel rocket launcher	38-90 km
Pinaka-ER	extended range	75 km
Pralay	quasi-ballistic	150-500 km
Shaurya	hypersonic	750 km

Recent indigenous defence platforms

- **INS Vikrant** — India's first indigenous aircraft carrier; commissioned Sep 2022 at Cochin Shipyard.

- **INS Arihant** — India's first indigenous nuclear-powered ballistic-missile submarine (SSBN) — completed nuclear triad. INS Arighat, INS Aridaman to follow.
- **INS Vagir, Vagsheer** — Project-75 Scorpene-class diesel-electric submarines.
- **HAL Tejas Mk-1A** — light combat aircraft; Mk-2 (medium combat) under development.
- **TAPAS BH-201** — DRDO's medium-altitude long-endurance UAV.
- **Rustom-II / TAPAS** — DRDO MALE UAV.
- **AMCA** (Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft) — 5th-gen stealth fighter under development.
- **Arjun Mk-1A** — main battle tank (DRDO + HVF Avadi).
- **Dhanush, Sharang** — artillery guns (155 mm).
- **K-9 Vajra-T** — self-propelled artillery (L&T + Hanwha).
- **NETRA** — DRDO airborne early-warning + control (AEW&C); follow-on Netra Mk-1A, Mk-2.

Recent / repeat military exercises (high-yield)

Exercise	Partner	Type
Yudh Abhyas	USA	Army
Vajra Prahar	USA	Special Forces
Cope India	USA	Air
Malabar	USA + Japan + Australia	Naval (QUAD)
Tiger Triumph	USA	Tri-services amphibious
Mitra Shakti	Sri Lanka	Army
SLINEX	Sri Lanka	Naval
Indra	Russia	Tri-services
Hand-in-Hand	China	Army (rare; suspended post-Galwan)
JIMEX	Japan	Naval
Dharma Guardian	Japan	Army
Ekuverin	Maldives	Army
Surya Kiran	Nepal	Army
Nomadic Elephant	Mongolia	Army
Garuda	France	Air
Varuna	France	Naval
Shakti	France	Army
Konkan	UK	Naval
Ajeya Warrior	UK	Army

Exercise	Partner	Type
Indradhanush	UK	Air
AUSINDEX	Australia	Naval
AUSTRA HIND	Australia	Army
Sampriti	Bangladesh	Army
Bongosagar	Bangladesh	Naval
Maitree	Thailand	Army
Dosti	Maldives + Sri Lanka	Coast Guard
Vinbax	Vietnam	UN engineering
Khanjar	Kyrgyzstan	Special Forces
Tarkash	USA NSG	counter - terror
Cobra Warrior	UK	multilateral air
Rim of the Pacific (RIMPAC)	25+ nations	naval (USA - led)
Red Flag	USA	air (multilateral)
Tarang Shakti	30 nations	India's largest multilateral air exercise (2024 first edition)

Defence procurement schemes

- **Make in India** (Defence) — emphasising indigenous manufacture.
- **iDEX** (Innovations for Defence Excellence) — DRDO + DPSU + start-ups.
- **Strategic Partnership model** — Indian companies tying up with foreign OEMs.
- **Negative Imports List** — items that can ONLY be procured indigenously (5 lists released 2020-2024).

PART Z — COMPUTER FUNDAMENTALS DEEP-DRILL

Z.1 Generations of computers

Generation	Period	Key device
1st	1946-59	vacuum tubes (ENIAC, UNIVAC)
2nd	1959-65	transistors (IBM 1401, 7094)
3rd	1965-71	integrated circuits (IBM 360)
4th	1971-present	VLSI / microprocessors (Intel, Apple, IBM PC)
5th	future	AI, ULSI, parallel processing, quantum

Z.2 Computer architecture (Von Neumann)

- **CPU** = Control Unit (CU) + Arithmetic Logic Unit (ALU) + Registers.
- **Memory hierarchy** (fast → slow):
 - Registers (in CPU, ns)
 - Cache (L1, L2, L3 — SRAM)
 - Main Memory (RAM — DRAM)
 - Secondary storage (HDD, SSD)
 - Tertiary (optical, tape)
- **Buses** — Address (where), Data (what), Control (how).

Z.3 Memory units

Unit	Bytes
1 nibble	4 bits
1 byte	8 bits
1 kilobyte (KB)	1,024 B
1 megabyte (MB)	1,024 KB
1 gigabyte (GB)	1,024 MB
1 terabyte (TB)	1,024 GB
1 petabyte (PB)	1,024 TB
1 exabyte (EB)	1,024 PB
1 zettabyte (ZB)	1,024 EB
1 yottabyte (YB)	1,024 ZB

Z.4 Number systems

System	Base	Digits
Binary	2	0, 1
Octal	8	0 - 7
Decimal	10	0 - 9
Hexadecimal	16	0 - 9, A - F

- ASCII — 7 bits (128 chars); extended ASCII 8 bits (256).
- UTF-8 — variable-width Unicode, ASCII-compatible.
- BCD — Binary Coded Decimal (4 bits per digit).

Z.5 Software taxonomy

- **System software** — OS, device drivers, utility programs, language translators (assembler / compiler / interpreter).
- **Application software** — word processors, spreadsheets, browsers, databases.
- **Open-source** — Linux, Apache, MySQL, Python, Firefox.
- **Proprietary** — Windows, MS Office, Photoshop.

Z.6 Operating systems

- **Linux** (Linus Torvalds, 1991), Ubuntu, Debian, Red Hat, Fedora, Arch.
- **Windows** — Microsoft (1985-).
- **macOS** — Apple (Unix-based).
- **Android** — Google (Linux-based; mobile).
- **iOS** — Apple (mobile).
- **Chrome OS** — Google (browser-based).
- **BharatOS (BHRAT-OS)** — IIT Madras + JandKops; Indian mobile OS.

Z.7 Networking — OSI 7 layers

Layer	Function	Example protocol
7. Application	end-user services	HTTP, FTP, SMTP, DNS, SSH
6. Presentation	encoding, encryption	SSL/TLS, JPEG, ASCII
5. Session	session management	NetBIOS, RPC
4. Transport	reliability, flow control	TCP, UDP
3. Network	routing	IP, ICMP, OSPF, BGP
2. Data Link	frames, MAC	Ethernet, PPP, ARP
1. Physical	bits over wire	Cables, hubs, RJ-45

Mnemonic (top to bottom): "All People Seem To Need Data Processing".

Z.8 TCP/IP suite (4 layers)

TCP/IP layer	OSI equivalents
Application	7 + 6 + 5
Transport	4
Internet	3
Network access	2 + 1

Z.9 Network terms

- **LAN** — Local Area Network (within building).
- **WAN** — Wide Area Network (continents — internet).
- **MAN** — Metropolitan Area Network (city).
- **PAN** — Personal Area Network (Bluetooth).
- **VPN** — Virtual Private Network (encrypted tunnel).
- **VLAN** — Virtual LAN (logical segmentation).
- **IP address** — IPv4: 32-bit (4.3 billion addresses); IPv6: 128-bit (3.4×10^{38}).
- **MAC address** — 48-bit hardware address (e.g., 00:1A:2B:3C:4D:5E).
- **DNS** — Domain Name System; resolves names to IPs.
- **DHCP** — Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol; assigns IPs.
- **NAT** — Network Address Translation.
- **HTTP** — port 80; **HTTPS** — port 443; **SSH** — 22; **FTP** — 21; **SMTP** — 25; **DNS** — 53.

Z.10 Internet milestones

Year	Event
1969	ARPANET launched (DARPA, USA)
1971	First email (Ray Tomlinson) — @ sign chosen
1983	TCP/IP becomes standard
1989	World Wide Web proposed (Tim Berners-Lee at CERN)
1990	First web browser ("WorldWideWeb" by Berners-Lee)
1993	Mosaic browser
1995	Internet commercial in India (VSNL on 15 Aug)
1998	Google founded (Larry Page + Sergey Brin)
2004	Facebook founded (Mark Zuckerberg)

Year	Event
2005	YouTube founded
2006	Twitter founded
2007	iPhone launched
2008	Android released
2010	Instagram founded
2011	IPv6 launch
2017	Reliance Jio rolls out 4G in India
2022	5G commercial launch in India (Oct, by Airtel + Jio)
2022	ChatGPT launched (Nov 30, OpenAI)
2023	Threads, Bard, Gemini, Llama, Claude — generative-AI mainstream
2024	India crosses 1 billion internet users ; UPI cross-border live in 7 countries

Z.11 AI / ML / blockchain (basics)

- **AI** = systems performing tasks that normally need human intelligence.
- **Narrow AI** — excels at one task (chess, image classification).
- **General AI (AGI)** — human-level breadth (still hypothetical).
- **Machine Learning** = AI subfield; learns patterns from data.
- **Supervised** — labelled data (regression, classification).
- **Unsupervised** — unlabelled data (clustering, PCA).
- **Reinforcement** — reward-based learning (game-playing, robotics).
- **Deep Learning** = ML using multi-layer neural networks (CNN for images, RNN/LSTM/Transformer for sequences).
- **Generative AI** — produces new content (text, image, audio, video). Models: GPT (OpenAI), Gemini (Google), Claude (Anthropic), Llama (Meta).
- **Blockchain** = distributed immutable ledger; basis of cryptocurrency.
- **Bitcoin** (Satoshi Nakamoto, 2009) — first cryptocurrency.
- **Ethereum** — programmable smart contracts.
- **Web3** — decentralised internet built on blockchain.
- **NFT** — non-fungible token; unique digital asset.
- **Quantum computing** — uses qubits (superposition, entanglement); IBM, Google, IonQ leaders.

Z.12 Indian IT-government schemes

- **Digital India** (2015) — pillars: digital infrastructure, governance + services on demand, digital empowerment.
- **BharatNet** — fibre to gram panchayats (NOFN).
- **Aadhaar** — UIDAI; world's largest biometric ID (>1.3 billion).

- **DigiLocker** — cloud document storage; Aadhaar-linked.
- **eSign** — Aadhaar-based electronic signature.
- **e-Sanjeevani** — telemedicine.
- **DIKSHA** — teacher + student learning platform.
- **CoWIN** — vaccine registration platform; open-sourced globally.
- **Aarogya Setu** — COVID contact-tracing app.
- **mPassport Seva, mAadhaar, mParivahan** — m-governance.
- **GeM (Government e-Marketplace)** — public procurement portal.
- **IndiaAI Mission** — ₹10,371 cr; computing infra + datasets + AI startups + IndiaAI dataset platform.
- **National Quantum Mission (NQM)** — ₹6,003 cr; 4 thematic hubs (computing, communication, sensing, materials).

PART W — BIOTECH RECENT (extension)

- **CRISPR-Cas9** — Jennifer Doudna + Emmanuelle Charpentier (Nobel 2020).
- **mRNA vaccines** — Pfizer/BioNTech, Moderna (2020); Karikó + Weissman (Nobel Medicine 2023) for nucleoside-modified mRNA.
- **Indian COVID vaccines** — Covishield (Serum Institute), Covaxin (Bharat Biotech, indigenous, killed-virus), Corbevax (Biological E), Sputnik V (Russia, manufactured in India), ZyCoV-D (Zydus, world's first DNA vaccine), iNCOVACC (Bharat Biotech, intranasal).
- **Genome India Project** — 10,000-Indian genome sequencing programme (DBT).
- **Gene therapy approvals** — for sickle-cell disease (Casgevy by Vertex/CRISPR Tx, Dec 2023, FDA — first CRISPR-based therapy approved).
- **GM crops in India** — only Bt cotton (commercial since 2002); Bt brinjal under moratorium; GM mustard (DMH-11) approved for environmental release Oct 2022 — but stayed by Supreme Court.

Parts X–W are particularly current (2024–26) and should be reviewed annually as ISRO/DRDO add new operational systems.

PART V — NOBEL PRIZES 2020-2024 (full 5 years)

Physics

Year	Laureates	For
2020	Roger Penrose, Reinhard Genzel, Andrea Ghez	Black holes; supermassive black hole at galactic centre
2021	Syukuro Manabe, Klaus Hasselmann, Giorgio Parisi	Climate models + complex physical systems
2022	Alain Aspect, John Clauser, Anton Zeilinger	Quantum entanglement experiments + Bell inequalities
2023	Pierre Agostini, Ferenc Krausz, Anne L'Huillier	Attosecond pulses (electron motion)
2024	John Hopfield + Geoffrey Hinton	Foundational discoveries in artificial neural networks ("Godfathers of AI")
2025	John Clarke + Michel H. Devoret + John M. Martinis	Macroscopic quantum-mechanical tunnelling + energy quantisation in superconducting circuits

Chemistry

Year	Laureates	For
2020	Emmanuelle Charpentier + Jennifer Doudna	CRISPR-Cas9 gene editing
2021	Benjamin List + David MacMillan	Asymmetric organocatalysis
2022	Carolyn Bertozzi, Morten Meldal, K. Barry Sharpless	Click chemistry + bioorthogonal chemistry (Sharpless 2nd Nobel after 2001)
2023	Moungi Bawendi, Louis Brus, Alexei Ekimov	Quantum dots
2024	David Baker (computational protein design) + Demis Hassabis + John Jumper (AlphaFold — predicting protein structure)	Protein structure prediction
2025	Susumu Kitagawa (Japan) + Richard Robson (Australia) + Omar M. Yaghi (USA)	Metal-organic frameworks (MOFs) — porous materials with applications in gas storage, drug delivery, catalysis

Medicine / Physiology

Year	Laureates	For
2020	Harvey Alter, Michael Houghton, Charles Rice	Hepatitis C virus discovery
2021	David Julius + Ardem Patapoutian	Receptors for temperature + touch

Year	Laureates	For
2022	Svante Pääbo	Genomes of extinct hominins (Neanderthal); founder of paleogenomics
2023	Katalin Karikó + Drew Weissman	mRNA vaccines (foundational nucleoside-modified mRNA work)
2024	Victor Ambros + Gary Ruvkun	microRNA discovery + post-transcriptional gene regulation
2025	Mary E. Brunkow + Fred Ramsdell (USA) + Shimon Sakaguchi (Japan)	Regulatory T cells — peripheral immune tolerance; how immune system avoids attacking own body

Literature

Year	Laureate	Country
2020	Louise Glück	USA
2021	Abdulrazak Gurnah	Tanzania-UK
2022	Annie Ernaux	France
2023	Jon Fosse	Norway
2024	Han Kang	South Korea (first Asian woman)
2025	László Krasznahorkai	Hungary — for "compelling and visionary oeuvre that, in midst of apocalyptic terror, reaffirms power of art"

Peace

Year	Laureate	For
2020	World Food Programme (WFP)	Hunger relief
2021	Maria Ressa + Dmitry Muratov	Press freedom
2022	Ales Bialiatski (Belarus) + Memorial (Russia) + CCL (Ukraine)	Human rights
2023	Narges Mohammadi (Iran, in jail)	Women's rights in Iran
2024	Nihon Hidankyo (Japan)	Hibakusha (atomic bomb survivors); push for nuclear-weapon abolition
2025	María Corina Machado (Venezuela)	For tireless work promoting democratic rights for the people of Venezuela

Economics

Year	Laureates	For
2020	Paul Milgrom + Robert Wilson	Auction theory

Year	Laureates	For
2021	David Card, Joshua Angrist, Guido Imbens	Empirical labour economics; natural experiments
2022	Ben Bernanke, Douglas Diamond, Philip Dybvig	Banks + financial crises
2023	Claudia Goldin	Women in labour market (only 3rd woman; first solo woman in Economics)
2024	Daron Acemoglu, Simon Johnson, James Robinson	Why nations succeed/fail (institutions)
2025	Joel Mokyr (Israeli-American) + Philippe Aghion (France) + Peter Howitt (Canada)	Innovation-driven economic growth

PART W — RECENT (2024-26) SCIENCE & TECH BREAKTHROUGHS

Space (2024-26)

- **Chandrayaan-3** (Aug 2023) — India 4th nation to soft-land on Moon; 1st near south pole.
- **Aditya-L1** placed at L1 (Jan 2024) — India's first solar mission.
- **XPoSat** (Jan 2024) — India's X-ray polarimeter satellite.
- **SpaDeX** (Dec 2024 launch; docking 16 Jan 2025) — India 4th country to demonstrate space-docking.
- **Gaganyaan TV-D1** (Oct 2023) — crew-escape test.
- **Gaganyaan astronauts announced** (Feb 2024) — Prashanth Nair, Ajit Krishnan, Angad Pratap, Shubhanshu Shukla.
- **NISAR** (launched **30 Jul 2025** by GSLV-F16, per ISRO official) — joint NASA-ISRO Earth-observation Synthetic Aperture Radar satellite.
- **NASA Artemis-2** (planned 2025-26) — first crewed mission around Moon since 1972.
- **SpaceX Starship** test flights (2023-25) — multiple integrated flight tests; world's largest rocket.
- **JWST** (James Webb Space Telescope, launched 2021) — operational; deepest infrared images ever.
- **Euclid telescope** (ESA, launched 2023) — dark matter + dark energy mapping.

AI / ML / computing

- **ChatGPT** (Nov 2022) — first widely-used LLM; OpenAI; led to ChatGPT-4 (Mar 2023), GPT-4o (May 2024), GPT-5 (mid-2025).
- **DALL-E, Midjourney, Stable Diffusion** — text-to-image generators.
- **Sora, Veo, Runway** — text-to-video.
- **Google Gemini** (Dec 2023) — multimodal; **Gemini 2.0** (Dec 2024).
- **Anthropic Claude 3.5 Sonnet** (Jun 2024) — frontier reasoning model.
- **Llama 3.1** (Meta, Jul 2024) — open-source 405B parameter model.
- **DeepMind AlphaFold-3** (May 2024) — protein-structure prediction with arbitrary biomolecules.
- **NVIDIA H100, H200, B100** — GPUs powering AI training.
- **ChatGPT Search** (Oct 2024) — search integration.

Biotech / health

- **CRISPR-Cas9** therapy (Casgevy, Vertex/CRISPR Tx, Dec 2023, FDA) — first CRISPR-based therapy for sickle cell + beta-thalassemia.
- **AlphaFold 3** (Google DeepMind, May 2024) — biomolecular structure prediction.
- **GLP-1 receptor agonists** (Ozempic/Wegovy, Mounjaro) — for diabetes + obesity.
- **mRNA flu vaccine** in Phase III (Moderna 2024).
- **Universal cancer vaccine** prototypes (mRNA-based, BioNTech 2025 trials).
- **Anti-aging research** — senolytic drugs in trials.
- **Pig kidney transplant** (Massachusetts General Hospital, Mar 2024) — first to a living human.
- **First womb transplant + birth** in India (AIIMS Delhi 2024).

Climate + energy

- **Net-zero pledges** — India 2070; China 2060; EU 2050; USA 2050.
- **EV adoption** — India FAME-II + III subsidy schemes; 2030 target 30% new sales electric.
- **Green hydrogen mission** (India, Jan 2023) — ₹19,744 cr; 5 MMT/yr by 2030.
- **Bhadla Solar Park** (Rajasthan) — world's largest solar park (~2.25 GW).
- **Pavagada Solar Park** (Karnataka) — 2.05 GW.
- **First fully indigenous nuclear reactor** — KAPP-3 (Kakrapar, GJ) operational 2023.
- **Fast Breeder Reactor** (Kalpakkam, TN) — operational 2024 (3-stage nuclear program).
- **Fusion progress** — National Ignition Facility (USA) achieved net energy gain (Dec 2022; replicated 2024).
- **ITER** (France, intl) — under construction; first plasma 2025-2026 target.

Materials + electronics

- **Semiconductor manufacturing in India** — Tata-PSMC fabs (GJ); Micron OSAT (GJ); CG Power (GJ).
- **2 nm chip** mass production (TSMC, 2025).
- **Quantum computing** — IBM 1000-qubit Condor (Dec 2023); Google Willow chip (Dec 2024) — quantum error-correction milestone.
- **Room-temperature superconductor** (LK-99, claimed July 2023) — discredited but research continues.

Defence

- **Mission Divyastra** (Mar 2024) — Agni-V with MIRV (Multiple Independently-targetable Reentry Vehicle) tested.
- **ET-LDHCM (Extended Trajectory-Long Duration Hypersonic Cruise Missile)** — DRDO tested 14 Jul 2025; **Mach 8** (~9,800 km/h) speed.
- **Scramjet long-duration ground test** (9 Jan 2026) — over 12 minutes; powers hypersonic missile programme.
- **Vertically-Launched SR-SAM** flight-test (26 Mar 2025, Indian Navy).
- **MRSAM Army version** — 4 successful flight-tests (3-4 Apr 2025) from APJ Abdul Kalam Island, Odisha.
- **MPATGM (Man-Portable Anti-Tank Guided Missile)** — top-attack capability test (11 Jan 2026).
- **Agni-V test** (Aug 2025) — range >5,000 km, from Odisha.
- **INS Vikrant** (Sep 2022) — first indigenous aircraft carrier.
- **INS Arighat** (Aug 2024) — second nuclear submarine (Arihant class).
- **HAL Tejas Mk-1A** delivery (2024).
- **AMCA** (Advanced Medium Combat Aircraft) — 5th-gen stealth fighter; design phase complete 2024.
- **Akash NG** SAM operational (2024).
- **K-4 SLBM** test (Jan 2025) — 3,500 km range.
- **Tarang Shakti** (Aug 2024) — India's largest multilateral air exercise (30 nations).

Indian computer-science / digital

- **5G nationwide rollout** completed 2024 (Reliance Jio + Airtel + Vi). **India = 2nd largest 5G user base globally (after China)** — **394 million 5G users by end-2025**; mid-band 5G covers >90% of population.

- **6G research** — TSDSI 6G Vision document (2023); Bharat 6G Mission (2023, ₹1 trillion outlay); **Bharat 6G Alliance now 84+ members**; 6G Apex Council met 10 Dec 2025.
- **Indigenous 4G stack** rolled out by PM Modi on 27 Sep 2025 — **India 5th country in world** with own 4G stack (upgradable to 5G).
- **Internet users milestone** — India crossed **1 billion broadband subscribers in November 2025** (TRAI; 100.29 crore; up from 25.15 crore in March 2014).
- **CBDC retail** (₹) live in 9 cities; programmable + offline pilots.
- **DigiYatra** at 28+ airports (face-recognition boarding).
- **Aadhaar** crosses 1.4 billion enrolments (2024).
- **UPI** crosses 18-20 billion txns/month (2026); UPI live in 7+ countries.

Health (India)

- **Ayushman Bharat (PM-JAY)** — covers 50+ crore citizens with ₹5L cover.
- **Jan Aushadhi** — 14,000+ stores (generic medicines).
- **eSanjeevani** telemedicine — 200+ million consultations.
- **iNCOVACC** — Bharat Biotech intranasal COVID vaccine.
- **ZyCoV-D** (Zydus, Aug 2021) — world's first DNA vaccine.

PART U — SCI-TECH MINI-MOCK (25 Questions · 25 Minutes)

Set a timer. No looking back. Check the answer key at the end.

1. Chandrayaan-3's Vikram lander touched down on the Moon on:

- (a) 14 July 2023 (b) 23 August 2023
(c) 5 September 2023 (d) 1 January 2024

2. India's Aditya-L1 solar mission was positioned at which Lagrange point?

- (a) L1 (b) L2 (c) L4 (d) L5

3. India became the 4th country to demonstrate space docking through mission:

- (a) NISAR (b) Gaganyaan (c) SpaDeX (d) GSAT-20

4. India's first indigenous aircraft carrier is:

- (a) INS Vikramaditya (b) INS Viraat
(c) INS Vikrant (d) INS Arihant

5. Which ISRO mission was India's first interplanetary mission?

- (a) Chandrayaan-1
(b) Chandrayaan-2
(c) Aditya-L1
(d) Mars Orbiter Mission (Mangalyaan)

6. Mission Divyastra (March 2024) demonstrated which capability of Agni-V?

- (a) Hypersonic glide
(b) MIRV (Multiple Independently Targetable Re-entry Vehicles)
(c) Submarine launch
(d) Anti-satellite

7. The Nobel Prize in Physics 2024 was awarded for work on:

- (a) CRISPR gene editing
(b) Foundational discoveries enabling machine learning with artificial neural networks
(c) Quantum entanglement
(d) Gravitational waves

8. What does "DNA" in ZyCoV-D (Zydus COVID vaccine) signify?

- (a) It is made from inactivated virus
(b) It is a DNA plasmid vaccine — the world's first DNA vaccine
(c) It delivers mRNA
(d) It is a protein subunit vaccine

9. India's net-zero emissions target year is:

- (a) 2050 (b) 2060 (c) 2070 (d) 2075

10. Which layer of the OSI model is responsible for routing packets between networks?

- (a) Data Link (b) Network (c) Transport (d) Session

11. 1 Terabyte (TB) equals how many Gigabytes?

- (a) 1,000 (b) 1,024 (c) 1,048 (d) 10,000

12. AlphaFold, the AI tool that predicted protein structures, was developed by:

- (a) OpenAI (b) Microsoft Research
(c) Google DeepMind (d) IBM Watson

13. The first CRISPR-based therapy (Casgevy) approved by the US FDA in December 2023 is used to treat:

- (a) Alzheimer's disease
(b) Sickle cell disease and beta-thalassemia
(c) HIV/AIDS
(d) Type 1 diabetes

14. NISAR is a joint Earth observation satellite of ISRO and:

- (a) ESA (b) JAXA (c) NASA (d) Roscosmos

15. BrahMos is a supersonic cruise missile jointly developed by India and:

- (a) USA (b) France (c) Russia (d) Israel

16. India's first nuclear submarine (INS Arihant) belongs to which class?

- (a) Akula (b) Arihant (c) Chakra (d) Scorpene

17. Which Indian satellite launch vehicle is used for heavier geosynchronous satellites?

- (a) PSLV (b) SSLV (c) GSLV (d) SLV-3

18. India's National Space Day is celebrated on:

- (a) 15 August (b) 22 October (c) 23 August (d) 14 November

19. The Bhadla Solar Park, the world's largest solar park, is located in:

- (a) Gujarat (b) Tamil Nadu (c) Karnataka (d) Rajasthan

20. India's 3-stage nuclear programme was designed by:

- (a) A.P.J. Abdul Kalam (b) Homi J. Bhabha
(c) Vikram Sarabhai (d) Raja Ramanna

21. Which protocol is used for sending emails?

- (a) HTTP (b) FTP (c) SMTP (d) POP3

22. The first generation of computers used:

- (a) Transistors (b) Integrated circuits
(c) Vacuum tubes (d) Microprocessors

23. World's first DNA vaccine for COVID-19 was developed by:

- (a) Serum Institute (b) Bharat Biotech
(c) Zydus Lifesciences (d) ICMR

24. India's target for Green Hydrogen production by 2030 is:

- (a) 1 MMT/yr (b) 3 MMT/yr (c) 5 MMT/yr (d) 10 MMT/yr

25. The Nobel Peace Prize 2024 was awarded to:

- (a) Greta Thunberg
(b) WHO
(c) Nihon Hidankyo (Japanese atomic bomb survivors' organisation)
(d) Julian Assange

Answer Key

1-b | 2-a | 3-c | 4-c | 5-d | 6-b | 7-b | 8-b | 9-c | 10-b | 11-b | 12-c | 13-b | 14-c | 15-c | 16-b | 17-c | 18-c | 19-d |
20-b | 21-c | 22-c | 23-c | 24-c | 25-c

Score: 23–25 = Excellent · 18–22 = Good · Below 18 = Re-read Parts A (Space), B (Defence), and T (Computer Awareness).

EXAM ALERT

Error-log rule: For every question you got wrong, write one sentence explaining what you missed. Retest yourself on only those questions 3 days later — without looking at the solution. Re-reading alone does not fix the gap; active recall does.

Review the "What's New" section before every exam — ISRO and DRDO add new milestones regularly and Nobel laureates are announced each October.

PART T — COMPUTER AWARENESS DEEP-DRILL (Banks GA + SSC + RRB)

Computer Awareness carries 5-10 marks in Banks Mains GA, 2-3 in SSC CHSL/CGL Tier-2 (Computer Knowledge), 2-3 in RRB NTPC. Drill these tables to mastery.

T.1 Hardware components (revisit)

Component	Function
CPU	Brain; CU + ALU + Registers
RAM	Volatile working memory; lost on power - off
ROM	Non - volatile boot storage; PROM, EPROM, EEPROM variants
Cache	Fast SRAM near CPU (L1, L2, L3)
HDD	Magnetic platter storage; mechanical
SSD	Flash - based; faster, no moving parts
GPU	Graphics + parallel computation (AI training)
Motherboard	Main circuit board
Power Supply (SMPS)	Converts AC to DC
Monitor / Display	Output (LCD, LED, OLED, AMOLED, CRT)
Keyboard, Mouse	Input devices
Scanner	Input (image / OCR)
Printer	Output (Inkjet, Laser, Dot Matrix, Plotter, 3 - D)
Speaker	Output (audio)
Microphone	Input (audio)
Webcam	Input (video)
UPS	Uninterruptible Power Supply (battery backup)

T.2 Memory hierarchy + units (must know cold)

Unit	Bytes	Notes
1 nibble	4 bits	half - byte
1 byte	8 bits	smallest addressable
1 KB	1,024 B	(10^3 in SI)
1 MB	1,024 KB	

Unit	Bytes	Notes
1 GB	1,024 MB	
1 TB	1,024 GB	
1 PB	1,024 TB	petabyte
1 EB	1,024 PB	exabyte
1 ZB	1,024 EB	zettabyte
1 YB	1,024 ZB	yottabyte
1 word	16, 32, or 64 bits	machine - dependent

T.3 Software taxonomy

Type	Examples
System software	OS (Windows, Linux, macOS, Android, iOS); device drivers; utility (antivirus, defragmenter); language translators (assembler, compiler, interpreter, linker, loader)
Application software	MS Office, Adobe Photoshop, Tally, web browsers, email clients, games
Open - source	Linux, Apache, MySQL, Python, Firefox, LibreOffice
Proprietary	Windows, MS Office, Photoshop, Oracle DB
Freeware	Free to use; not necessarily open source (e.g., Skype, WhatsApp)
Shareware	Try - before - buy
Firmware	Embedded software in hardware (BIOS, router firmware)
Middleware	Connects different software (DBMS - app middleware)

T.4 Operating systems

- **Linux** — Linus Torvalds, 1991; Ubuntu, Debian, Fedora, Red Hat, CentOS, Arch.
- **Windows** — Microsoft (1985-): 1.0, 95, 98, XP, Vista, 7, 8, 10, 11.
- **macOS** — Apple (UNIX-based).
- **Android** — Google (Linux-based; mobile dominant).
- **iOS** — Apple (mobile).
- **Chrome OS** — Google (browser-based).
- **BharatOS (BHRAT-OS)** — IIT Madras + JandKops; Indian mobile OS (2023).

T.5 MS Office shortcuts (high-yield)

Universal

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+A	Select all

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+C	Copy
Ctrl+X	Cut
Ctrl+V	Paste
Ctrl+Z	Undo
Ctrl+Y	Redo
Ctrl+F	Find
Ctrl+H	Find + Replace
Ctrl+S	Save
Ctrl+P	Print
Ctrl+N	New
Ctrl+O	Open
Ctrl+W	Close window
Ctrl+B	Bold
Ctrl+I	Italic
Ctrl+U	Underline
Alt+Tab	Switch windows
Win+L	Lock screen
Win+D	Show desktop
F1	Help
F5	Refresh / Slideshow (PowerPoint)
F12	Save As

Word

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+Shift+L	Apply bullets
Ctrl+Shift+N	Apply normal style
Ctrl+E	Centre alignment
Ctrl+J	Justify
Ctrl+L	Left-align
Ctrl+R	Right-align

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+Enter	Page break
Shift+F3	Toggle case
Ctrl+Shift+W	Underline words only
Ctrl+Shift+P	Change font size

Excel

Shortcut	Action
Ctrl+;	Insert today's date
Ctrl+Shift+;	Insert current time
F4	Toggle absolute reference
F2	Edit cell
Ctrl+1	Format Cells dialog
Alt+=	AutoSum
Ctrl+arrow	Jump to data edge
Ctrl+Shift+L	Toggle filter
Ctrl+T	Create table
F11	Quick chart
Alt+Enter	New line in cell

PowerPoint

Shortcut	Action
F5	Start from beginning
Shift+F5	Start from current slide
Esc	Exit slideshow
B / W	Black / white screen
Ctrl+M	New slide
Ctrl+D	Duplicate slide

T.6 Networking — OSI 7 layers (memorise)

Layer	Function	Protocol example
7. Application	end-user services	HTTP, HTTPS, FTP, SMTP, DNS, SSH, POP3, IMAP, Telnet

Layer	Function	Protocol example
6. Presentation	encoding, encryption	SSL/TLS, JPEG, MPEG, ASCII, EBCDIC
5. Session	session management	NetBIOS, RPC, SQL
4. Transport	end-to-end reliability	TCP, UDP, SCTP
3. Network	logical addressing, routing	IP, ICMP, OSPF, BGP, IGMP
2. Data Link	physical addressing, frames	Ethernet, PPP, ARP, MAC
1. Physical	bits over medium	Cables, hubs, RJ-45, fibre

Mnemonic top→bottom: "All People Seem To Need Data Processing". Mnemonic bottom→top: "Please Do Not Throw Sausage Pizza Away" (PDNTSPA).

T.7 TCP/IP (4 layers)

TCP/IP	OSI mapping
Application	7 + 6 + 5
Transport	4
Internet	3
Network access	2 + 1

T.8 Network terms + ports

Term	Meaning
LAN	Local Area Network (within building)
WAN	Wide Area Network (continents — internet)
MAN	Metropolitan Area Network (city)
PAN	Personal Area Network (Bluetooth)
WLAN	Wireless LAN (Wi-Fi)
VPN	Virtual Private Network (encrypted tunnel)
VLAN	Virtual LAN (logical segmentation)
Internet	global TCP/IP network
Intranet	private network within an org
Extranet	intranet with external partners
World Wide Web (WWW)	hypertext document system on internet

T.9 Common port numbers (must memorise)

Service	Port
HTTP	80
HTTPS	443
FTP	20 (data), 21 (control)
SSH	22
Telnet	23
SMTP (mail send)	25
DNS	53
DHCP	67/68
HTTP-Proxy	8080
POP3 (mail receive)	110
IMAP	143
SQL Server	1433
MySQL	3306
PostgreSQL	5432
MongoDB	27017
RDP (Remote Desktop)	3389

T.10 IP addressing

- **IPv4** — 32-bit (4 octets); ~4.3 billion addresses; format e.g., 192.168.1.1 .
- **IPv6** — 128-bit; 3.4×10^{38} addresses; format e.g., 2001:0db8:85a3::8a2e:0370:7334 .
- **Private IP ranges** (IPv4): 10.0.0.0/8 , 172.16.0.0/12 , 192.168.0.0/16 .
- **Loopback**: 127.0.0.1 (localhost).
- **MAC address** — 48-bit hardware address (e.g., 00:1A:2B:3C:4D:5E).
- **DNS** — Domain Name System (resolves names to IPs).
- **DHCP** — Dynamic Host Configuration Protocol (auto IP assignment).
- **NAT** — Network Address Translation (private → public IP).

T.11 Internet milestones (memorise)

Year	Event
1969	ARPANET (DARPA, USA) — birth of internet
1971	First email (Ray Tomlinson); @ chosen

Year	Event
1983	TCP/IP becomes standard
1989	WWW proposed (Tim Berners-Lee at CERN)
1990	First web browser ("WorldWideWeb" by Berners-Lee)
1993	Mosaic browser
1995	India's first internet (VSNL) on 15 Aug 1995
1998	Google founded (Larry Page + Sergey Brin)
2004	Facebook founded (Mark Zuckerberg)
2005	YouTube founded
2006	Twitter founded
2007	iPhone launched
2008	Android released
2010	Instagram founded
2017	Reliance Jio rolls out 4G in India
2022	5G commercial launch in India (Oct)
2022	ChatGPT launched (Nov 30, OpenAI)
2024	India crosses 1 billion internet users ; UPI cross-border live in 7 countries

T.12 Programming languages

Language	Year	Creator	Use
FORTRAN	1957	John Backus (IBM)	Scientific computing
LISP	1958	John McCarthy	AI
COBOL	1959	Grace Hopper	Business
BASIC	1964	Kemeny + Kurtz	Beginners
C	1972	Dennis Ritchie	System programming, Unix
C++	1985	Bjarne Stroustrup	Object-oriented
Java	1995	James Gosling (Sun)	Cross-platform; "Write once, run anywhere"
JavaScript	1995	Brendan Eich (Netscape)	Web browser
Python	1991	Guido van Rossum	General purpose, AI/ML
PHP	1994	Rasmus Lerdorf	Web backend
Ruby	1995	Yukihiro Matsumoto	Web (Ruby on Rails)

Language	Year	Creator	Use
Swift	2014	Apple	iOS apps
Kotlin	2011	JetBrains	Android
Go (Golang)	2009	Google	Backend systems
Rust	2010	Mozilla	Systems, safe concurrency
TypeScript	2012	Microsoft	JavaScript with types
R	1993	Ihaka + Gentleman	Statistics, data science
MATLAB	1984	Cleve Moler	Numerical computing
SQL	1974	IBM (Codd's relational model)	Database queries
HTML	1993	Tim Berners-Lee	Web markup

T.13 Database concepts

- **DBMS** — Database Management System (Oracle, MySQL, MS SQL, PostgreSQL).
- **RDBMS** — Relational DBMS; based on E.F. Codd's relational model (1970).
- **NoSQL** — non-relational (MongoDB, Cassandra, Redis).
- **SQL commands**: SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE, CREATE, DROP, ALTER, JOIN.
- **Primary key** — unique identifier for a row.
- **Foreign key** — references another table's primary key.
- **Normalisation** — eliminating redundancy (1NF, 2NF, 3NF, BCNF).
- **ACID** — Atomicity, Consistency, Isolation, Durability (transaction properties).

T.14 Cybersecurity terms

Term	Meaning
Virus	Self-replicating malicious code attached to host file
Worm	Standalone self-replicating program
Trojan	Disguised malware
Ransomware	Encrypts files; demands ransom (e.g., WannaCry 2017)
Spyware	Secretly monitors user
Adware	Shows unwanted ads
Phishing	Fake emails to steal credentials
Spear phishing	Targeted phishing
Smishing	Phishing via SMS
Vishing	Phishing via voice call
DDoS	Distributed Denial of Service (overwhelm server)

Term	Meaning
Man-in-the-middle	Intercepting communication
SQL injection	Inserting malicious SQL into input
XSS	Cross-Site Scripting
Zero-day	Newly discovered vulnerability before patch
Firewall	Filters network traffic
VPN	Virtual Private Network (encrypted tunnel)
Encryption	Converting data to unreadable form (AES, RSA)
Symmetric encryption	Same key for encrypt+decrypt (AES)
Asymmetric encryption	Public+private key pair (RSA)
Hash	One-way function (MD5, SHA-256)
Digital signature	Verifies authenticity + integrity
2FA / MFA	Two/Multi-factor authentication
CAPTCHA	"Completely Automated Public Turing test"
IT Act 2000	India's primary cyber law
CERT-In	Indian Computer Emergency Response Team
Cyber Crime Reporting	cybercrime.gov.in

T.15 Famous computer scientists

Person	Contribution
Charles Babbage	"Father of computer"; Analytical Engine (1837)
Ada Lovelace	"First computer programmer" (Babbage's engine)
Alan Turing	Turing Machine (1936); cracked Enigma; Father of AI/CS
John von Neumann	Von Neumann architecture (stored-program)
Grace Hopper	COBOL; coined "bug"; Navy Rear Admiral
Donald Knuth	"Art of Computer Programming"; TeX
Dennis Ritchie + Ken Thompson	C language + Unix (Bell Labs); Turing Award
Tim Berners-Lee	World Wide Web (1989)
Vint Cerf + Bob Kahn	TCP/IP — "Fathers of internet"
Linus Torvalds	Linux kernel (1991)
Bill Gates + Paul Allen	Microsoft (1975); Windows

Person	Contribution
Steve Jobs + Steve Wozniak	Apple (1976); iPhone (2007)
Mark Zuckerberg	Facebook (2004)
Larry Page + Sergey Brin	Google (1998)
Jeff Bezos	Amazon (1994)
Elon Musk	PayPal, Tesla, SpaceX, X (Twitter), xAI
Sundar Pichai	Google CEO (2015 -)
Satya Nadella	Microsoft CEO (2014 -)
Sam Altman	OpenAI CEO; ChatGPT
Geoffrey Hinton + Yann LeCun + Yoshua Bengio	Deep learning pioneers; Turing Award 2018
N.R. Narayana Murthy	Infosys co-founder
Azim Premji	Wipro Chairman emeritus

T.16 Computer Awareness mini-mock (15 Q)

1. Father of Computer? — Charles Babbage
2. WWW invented by? — Tim Berners-Lee (1989, CERN)
3. India's first internet day? — 15 Aug 1995 (VSNL)
4. Default port for HTTPS? — 443
5. RAM stands for? — Random Access Memory
6. ROM stands for? — Read Only Memory
7. Linux created by? — Linus Torvalds (1991)
8. Java created by? — James Gosling (Sun, 1995)
9. Python created by? — Guido van Rossum (1991)
10. India's IT Act year? — 2000
11. CERT-In stands for? — Indian Computer Emergency Response Team
12. ACID full form? — Atomicity, Consistency, Isolation, Durability
13. OSI total layers? — 7
14. SMTP port? — 25
15. India's mobile OS? — BharatOS (BHRAT-OS, IIT Madras + JandKops)

Computer Awareness covers ~5-10 marks in Banks Mains GA. These tables are mastery-level for that section.